



## PARLIAMENTARY DEBATES

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### OFFICIAL REPORT

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### CONTENTS

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#### VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND THE OFFICIAL REPORT— [Col. 1]

#### PAPERS—

- (a) Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the determination of the urgency of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025. — [Col. 30]
- (b) Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025. — [Col. 30]
- (c) An act to establish the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority— [Col. 65]
- (d) Report of the Committee on Education on the Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies (Amendment) Bill, 2025. — [Col. 149]
- (e) Report of the Committee on Education on the C.K. Tedam University of Technology and Applied Sciences (Amendment) Bill, 2025. — [Col. 149]
- (f) Report of the Committee on Education on the Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development (Amendment) Bill, 2025. — [Col. 149]
- (g) Report of the Budget Committee on Appropriation (No.2) Bill 2025. — [Col.155]

#### BILLS — FIRST READING

- (a) Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies (Amendment) Bill, 2025. — Col. 28]
- (b) C.K. Tedam University of Technology and Applied Sciences (Amendment) Bill, 2025.— [Col. 29]
- (c) Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development (Amendment) Bill, 2025— Col. 29]
- (d) Appropriation (No.2) Bill, 2025— [Col. 64]

#### BILLS — SECOND READING

- (a) Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025— [Col. 43]
- (b) Appropriation (No.2) Bill, 2025— [Col.157]

#### BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025— [Col. 67]

#### BILLS — THIRD READING

- (a) Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025— [Col. 10]

(b) Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025— [Col. 96, 151]

MOTION—

- (a) Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2011) — [Col. 13]
- (b) Determination of Urgency, Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025— [Col. 31]
- (c) Work Programme and Budget of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation — [100]

RESOLUTION—

Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2021) — [Col. 25]

ADJOURNMENT— [Col. 208]

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PARLIAMENT OF THE REPUBLIC  
OF GHANA

THIRD MEETING, 2025

Thursday, 18<sup>th</sup> December, 2025

*The House met at the Chamber,  
Parliament House, at 1:42 p.m.*

[HON FIRST DEPUTY SPEAKER,  
MR BERNARD AHIAFOR, IN THE  
CHAIR]

[PRAYERS]

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, Correction of *Votes* and *Proceedings* and the *Official Report*, the item numbered 5.

**VOTES AND PROCEEDINGS AND  
THE  
OFFICIAL REPORT**

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 17<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 is under correction.

Page 1...15— Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie, you have the floor?

**Mr Frank Afriyie:** Mr Speaker, I am profoundly grateful.

May I kindly bring you back to the page numbered 13, the item numbered 11 titled, “MOTION”, the line numbered 1. I recommend that we insert the word “the” after the word “adopt” and before “report”.

Thank you.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Table Office, take note.

Page 15...20— Yes, Hon Member?

**Mr Afriyie:** I was up on my feet when you mentioned the page numbered 18, the item numbered 18(2), the last line, I propose we delete the word there and insert the word “Statutes”.

Again, the item numbered 18(2), on the page numbered 18, which reads;

“The Council shall appoint the Pro Vice Chancellors for the University in accordance with the Statutes...”.

The word there should be deleted and replaced with the word “statutes”

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Table Office, take note.

Page 21—Yes, Hon Member?

**Mr Frank Annoh Dompheh:** Mr Speaker, if it pleases you, I tried to catch your attention—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Please flow.

**Mr Annoh-Dompheh:** Mr Speaker, on the page numbered 10, the Statement read by the Minister for Foreign Affairs. I thought the Statement was specific to Jamaica and Benin. But I see the title capturing a term “sister nations”, that I find vague and I do not know—If they have hard copies—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Well, Table Office can refer to the Statement—Yes, they can refer to the Statement and give it the correct caption.

Page 21...26— Yes, Hon Frank Afriyie?

**Mr Afriyie:** On the paragraph numbered (xviii) as written, “Ag Chief Executive Director”. With your kind indulgence delete the word “Director” and replace the same with “Officer”, to read “Ag Chief Executive Officer, Forestry Commission”.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** What is the correct designation? Is it an officer in really or a director?

**Mr Afriyie:** The right rendition should be Ag Chief Executive Officer (CEO).

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** But when we look at the item numbered (xix), is the name not “Mr Elikem Kotoko” where it is indicated that he is the Ag Chief Executive? All right; I have seen it. Table Office, take note.

Page 27...32— Yes, Hon Member?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** It is a general observation I wish to bring to you for guidance. I am a Member of the House Committee. I see the page numbered 32, capturing a meeting that was held by the House Committee on Saturday, 22<sup>nd</sup> November, 2025 and the same meeting by the Committee has been repeated on the page numbered 34.

Mr Speaker, my concern is that we are correcting *Votes and Proceedings* for Wednesday, 17<sup>th</sup> December, 2025, however, if you look at what has been added or attached, the dates are 22<sup>nd</sup> November and 23<sup>rd</sup> November; it does not gel and reflect the *Votes and Proceedings*.

Mr Speaker, may have to direct that the Table Office should—The harm has already been caused but going into the future it has to reflect.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, I agree with you. Table Office reconcile the dates.

Page 33...35—Yes?

**Mr Afriyie:** Mr Speaker, the page numbered 34, the item numbered 1, the second line, can we delete the word there after the word “Alisa” and insert “Hotel”.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** We should insert what word?

**Mr Afriyie:** The word “Hotel” after the word “Alisa”. In an attempt to write the word hotel, it has been wrongly spelt.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. Table Office, take note.

1:52 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Page 36...40 —

Hon Members, the *Votes and Proceedings* of Wednesday, 17<sup>th</sup>

December, 2025 as corrected is hereby adopted as the true record of proceedings.

Hon Members, we have four *Official Reports* for your consideration. First is the *Official Report* of Thursday, 4<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 under correction. Hon Members, any correction?

*[No correction was made to the Official Report of Thursday, 4<sup>th</sup> December, 2025.]*

Now we have the *Official Report* of Wednesday, 10<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 under correction. Hon Members, any corrections?

*[No correction was made to the Official Report of Wednesday, 10<sup>th</sup> December, 2025.]*

Hon Members, *Official Report* of Thursday, 11<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 for your correction.

*[No correction was made to the Official Report of Thursday, 11<sup>th</sup> December, 2025.]*

The last is *Official Report* of Friday, 12<sup>th</sup> December, 2025. Hon Members, any correction.

*[No correction was made to the Official Report of Friday, 12<sup>th</sup> December, 2025.]*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, permit me to acknowledge the presence of Global Media Foundation, led by Adama Alhassan and Rafael

Godlove Ahenu. They are from Sunyani East and they are 38 in number.

We have the Church of Pentecost, Sakumono, led by Rev Seth Amoakohene Addai. They are from Tema West and 14 number.

We also have Shekinah Glory School, led by Emmanuel Laryea, a teacher. They are from Ledzokuku and 29 in number.

*[Members of Global Media Foundation were acknowledged.]*

*[Members of Church of Pentecost, Tema West were acknowledged.]*

*[Students from Shekinah Glory School were acknowledged.]*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Majority Chief Whip, any indication?

**Majority Chief Whip (Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor):** Mr Speaker, may we seek your leave to take Motion numbered 35, as advertised.

**Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh):** Mr Speaker, we are trying to align. However, as the Majority Chief Whip knows, we are heading towards the last days.

So, just to remind him that he should make sure that all the outstanding matters that have to be dealt with are dealt with. I can see my good friend, Hon Kofi Adams, who is eager for his Bill to be considered. Today, he is

smiling. Yesterday, he was not smiling. But where is the Minister for Finance? The Minister is not here and his Deputy is equally not here. This is supposed to be a very important Bill and it is at Third Reading. It is not First Reading; it is Third Reading. We are ready to compromise, but tell us the reasons why, even the Deputy is not here. I saw Hon Thomas Nyarko Ampem this morning. For the record, tell us why Hon Ampem is not here, then we can compromise for him. He should tell the House something.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, they are tidying up for Appropriation, which is in an hour's time hopefully and the Deputy has also been detailed to see to the outstanding matters that were raised yesterday and the Hon Minority Chief Whip just reminded me. So, their absence is not in vain. It is to deal with the issues so that the House can be properly —

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** There is an indication that he is all right.

The item number 35. Motion, Minister for Finance.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, the Minister and his Deputy are unavoidably absent so may I seek your leave so that the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs may do this on his behalf?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, the application is that the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs should move the Motion numbered 35.

Yes, Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah?

**Mr Patrick Yaw Boamah:** Mr Speaker, thank you, I believe we are on the Third Reading.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** That is so.

**Mr Boamah:** May I refer, Mr Speaker to Standing Order 171. Before I move the Motion, yesterday I tabled my proposal to the Head of Table but I have had further consultations with my leadership and also the Chief Whip. It was going to be on the Budget of the Central Bank.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, but at the end of the day, they are asking permission for a Minister to move the Motion. The permission has not been granted so why are you on Order 171?

**Mr Boamah:** Mr Speaker, very well., if you are going toward Procedure, I will come back.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. So, Minority Chief Whip, the application is that the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs should —

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, he is friendly, not like others. So, we will accede to that call.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. Now, the Motion numbered 35 to be moved by the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious

Affairs on behalf of the Minister for Finance.

Yes, Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah, I can hear you now.

**Mr Boamah:** Let me read Standing Order 171;

“Where a Member intends to delete, amend or introduce a provision in a Bill which has passed through the Consideration Stage, the Member may, immediately before a sponsor rises to move the motion for the Third Reading of the Bill, move that the Bill passes through a second Consideration either wholly or in respect of a particular part or parts of the Bill or some proposed new clause or new Schedule.”

Mr Speaker, I intend to move this application to have the Bank of Ghana Amendment Bill go through a Second Consideration stage but I have had some consultation with my Leadership and also the mover of the Motion, who is a very diligent member of this House, not like the Chief Whip on the Majority Bench, my classmate from the Law Faculty.

Mr Speaker, with the way you have handled affairs so far, I am going to withdraw my application. Thank you.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs?

## **BILL — THIRD READING** **Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill,** **2025**

**Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs (Mr Ahmed Ibrahim) on behalf of the Minister for Finance:** Mr Speaker, before I proceed to move the Motion, I thank the distinguished Hon Patrick Yaw Boamah, who is very respected in this House for this good thing that he has done.

Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*, that the Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025, be now read the Third time.

2:02 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, Motions ably moved, any seconder?

**Chairperson of the Committee (Dr Eric Afful):** Mr Speaker, I rise to second the Motion.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

The Bank of Ghana (Amendment) Bill, 2025 – *read the Third time and passed.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Majority Chief Whip?

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, may we take the item numbered 9(b), and let me use the same opportunity to pray that the Hon Minister and his Deputy are unavoidably absent, so the Hon Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and

Religious Affairs should do that on his behalf.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, the instruction is that the laying of the item numbered 9(b) should wait, so they can finish working on it.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I am guided. May we then move to the item numbered 10.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Habib?

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, we do not have a problem with the Motion numbered 10. It is just that I am surprised because the only opportunity my good Friend, Alhaji Ahmed, had to build a relationship with the Minister for Finance so that he can get releases have actually been taken out of his mouth. If he had laid the Appropriation Bill on behalf of the Minister for Finance, the Minister would have known that the Hon Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs is doing his Business and for that matter, he would give him releases. Alhaji Ahmed has not been given any releases; he is suffering. He is holding about five Ministries; he is the Hon Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy, and Religious Affairs, Special Initiatives, and Aviation. Only him, yet nothing. If we go to the Ministry of Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs, we will not see Alhaji Ahmed because there is no money; there are no releases. All the major projects that were under him have no payment. Sanitation is with him, and they are not paying the service providers,

such as Zoomlion Ghana Limited and others; when we go out, everywhere is dirty because Alhaji Ahmed has no money. Now, he wanted to just build a relationship with the Minister for Finance, and that one too is taken out of his mouth.

Mr Speaker, I feel for Alhaji Ahmed, probably, maybe he should come back again. When I was the Hon First Deputy Majority Whip, he was the Hon First Deputy Minority Whip; at least we used to do things together. But this suffering he is going through with the Ministry is not good.

So, Hon Majority Chief Whip, even if the Hon Minister for Finance is here, and we are going to lay this, he should just let Alhaji Ahmed lay it so that he can have a relationship with the Hon Minister for Finance, who can give him more releases.

So, Mr Speaker, we can move on to the Motion numbered 10 — *[Laughter]*

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, that was a long introduction to a short story.

So, Mr Speaker, the Motion numbered 10 is a longstanding report, and we want to get it out of the way, and then we can deal with sports.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The Motion numbered 10, by the Chairperson of the Committee.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, the Chairperson has also stepped out, so I want to seek your leave for the Vice Chairperson to present the Report.



**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The application is that the Vice Chairperson should present the Report instead of the Chairperson.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, we have no objection.

## **MOTION**

### **Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2011)**

**Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Richard Acheampong)** *on behalf of the Chairperson:* Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Finance Committee on Agreement on Privileges, Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria 2011.

In so doing, Mr Speaker, I present your Committee's Report.

## **Introduction**

The "Ratification of the Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2011)" was laid in the House by the Hon Minister for Roads and Highways, Mr Kwame Agbodza on behalf of the Minister for Finance, Hon Cassiel Ato Forson on Friday, 1<sup>st</sup> August, 2025.

Mr Speaker referred the document to the Finance Committee for consideration and report in accordance with Standing Order 226 of the House.

## **Deliberations**

The Committee met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem and the technical team from the Ministry of Finance to deliberate on the Referral. The Committee is grateful to the Hon Deputy Minister and the officials for attending upon the Committee.

## **Reference Documents**

The Committee referred to the following documents:

- i. The 1992 Constitution.
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament.

## **Background**

The Declaration of Commitment on HIV/AIDS, adopted by the assembled Heads of State and Representatives of Governments at the Special Session of the 2001 United Nations General Assembly dedicated to HIV/AIDS, supported the creation, on an urgent basis, of a global HIV/AIDS and health fund.

Pursuant to that declaration, the Global Fund was established in Switzerland in 2002, to attract, manage and disburse resources to make a sustainable and significant contribution

to the reduction of infections, illness and death, thereby mitigating the impact of HIV/AIDS, tuberculosis and malaria in countries significantly impacted by those diseases.

The Fund concluded a Headquarters Agreement with the Government of Switzerland (the "Headquarters Agreement") in 2004, pursuant to which, Switzerland has conferred to the Global Fund and its officials, broad privileges and immunities.

The Fund currently enjoys privileges and immunities in 28 countries. Twenty countries have signed and, when required by domestic law, ratified the Agreement: Afghanistan, Belize, Burkina Faso, Burundi, Cote d'Ivoire, Eswatini, Ethiopia, Gabon, Georgia, Lesotho, Liberia, Malawi, Moldova, Mozambique, Niger, Rwanda, Sao Tome and Principe, Senegal, Togo, Uganda, and Zimbabwe. Five have conferred privileges and immunities by either bilateral agreements or domestic legislation: Benin, Djibouti, Kenya, Mauritania, Suriname, Switzerland and the United States.' Additionally, three countries have signed but not yet ratified the Agreement: the Republic of Ghana, Guinea Bissau and Montenegro.

As the first ever country to sign a Global Fund grant, the Republic of Ghana has been a key Global Fund partner since 2002. Most of the Global Fund's current funding for the period 2024-2026 (inclusive) is being implemented by the Ministry of Health

of the Republic of Ghana as Principal Recipient of two grants: TB/HIV and malaria.

On 6<sup>th</sup> June, 2011, Ghana also signed the Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria. Article 75(2) of the 1992 Constitution provides that a treaty, agreement or convention executed by or under the authority of the President shall be subject to ratification by-

- (a) Act of Parliament; or
- (b) a resolution of Parliament
- (c) supported by the votes of more than on-half of all the members of Parliament.

It is in fulfilment of the provisions under the Constitution that the Agreement has been laid in the House for ratification.

### **Articles of Agreement**

The Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria contains a total of eight articles under the following headings:

**Article I:** Judicial Personality;

**Article II:** Property, Funds and Assets;

**Article III:** Representatives of States and Other Persons Constituting

the Organs of the  
Global Fund;

**Article IV:** Officials;

**Article V:** Members of the  
Technical Review  
Panel, Technical  
Evaluation Reference  
Group and Experts on  
Mission;

**Article VI:** Settlement of Dispute  
with Third Parties;

**Article VII:** Settlement of  
Differences on the  
interpretation or  
application of the  
present agreement;  
and

**Article VIII:** Acceptance, Entry  
into force and Deposit.

## Observations

### Rationale for the Agreement

The Committee observed that the privileges and immunities requested by the Global Fund are those normally granted by countries to the United Nations, United Nations Specialized Agencies, multilateral development banks and other international organisations, including the Green Climate Fund and the ICRC. The protections that the Agreement would afford are, save that all issues relating to exemptions and waivers are subject to the Exemptions Act, 2022 (Act 1083), as follows:

- a) Protection of Global Fund resources dedicated to health in Ghana, including assets and property wheresoever located and by whomsoever held, from taxation, freeze and seizure.
- b) Prompt customs clearance and delivery of health products.
- c) Protection of the Global Fund from threatened or actual domestic lawsuits, both of which can endanger resources dedicated to health.
- d) Upholding the functional independence of the Global Fund, a multi-stakeholder organisation dedicated to achieving the United Nation's Millennium Development Goals.
- e) Enabling the Global Fund to operate with a comparable level of protections as those enjoyed by partner international organisations.
- f) Protection of the status and conditions for access and sojourn of Global Fund officials, experts and Board and Committee members on official mission.

Over the years, the Global Fund has contributed significantly to the Republic of Ghana's fight against HIV, TB and malaria and towards strengthening health and community systems and pandemic preparedness. Between 2010 and 2023, HIV incidence in the country reduced by 19 per cent and AIDS-related deaths

decreased by 35 per cent. Since 2015, the number of TB death reduced by 25 per cent and TB incidence rate by 19 per cent and malaria mortality reduced by 90 per cent as well as malaria case incidence by 70 per cent since 2019.

Reinforcing the Global Fund-Ghana partnership, a Framework Agreement was signed, effective as of 16 March 2015 (the “Framework Agreement”), committing the Republic of Ghana to, inter alia,

- (i) ensure that Global Fund financing, and the purchase and/or import of any goods or services using such funding, is exempt from relevant taxation; and
- (ii) take all appropriate and necessary actions to ensure that the Global Fund is accorded with privileges and immunities within three years from the effective date of the Framework Agreement.

The Global Fund and the Republic of Ghana have a shared interest in ensuring that these substantial health investments are protected through the conferral of privileges and immunities under the Agreement. By ratifying the Agreement, Ghana will also fulfil its obligations under the Framework Agreement signed in 2015 and the Global Fund can continue to operate effectively in the country.

### **Financial Impact**

The Committee observed that there is no foreseen financial impact regarding

the conferral of privileges and immunities to the Global Fund since tax exemptions have already been conferred to the Global Fund pursuant to the terms of the Framework Agreement between the Government of the Republic of Ghana and the Global Fund, effective on 16 March 2015.

### **Benefits to be derived**

The Committee observed that Ghana is the first ever country to sign a Global Fund grant. The country has been a key Global Fund partner since 2002. With the Republic of Ghana's recent allocation of US\$248 million for the period 2024 to 2026 (inclusive), Global Fund investments in the country are expected to reach up to US\$1.61 billion by 2026. This funding is intended to support the country's national HIV, TB and malaria programs, strengthen health systems and support Ghana's COVID-19 response. Further, by ratifying the Agreement, the Government in partnership with Global Fund would be able to:

- i. Continue with a number of health programmes;
- ii. Strengthen international partnerships; and
- iii. Protect resources dedicated to health in the country.

### **Conclusion**

The Committee has carefully considered the Agreement and is of the view that, when ratified, it would support the Government's efforts in maintaining

and strengthening Ghana's partnership with the Global Fund, which has played an essential role in improving Ghana's public health outcomes, reducing HIV, tuberculosis and malaria.

The Committee accordingly recommends to the House to adopt this report and ratify the Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria in accordance with article 75 (2) of the 1992 Constitution and the Standing Orders of the House.

Respectfully submitted.

*Question proposed.*

**Mr Issah Salifu Taylor (NDC — Tarkwa Nsuaem):** Mr Speaker, I rise to second the motion.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, the Motion has been seconded without comment. It is for the consideration of the House.

Alhaji Habib, are you in to contribute?

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu (NPP — Tolon):** Yes, Mr Speaker. I just want to have a small bite on it, because considering that this is important, the Committee reports on the Global Fund for fights on AIDS, tuberculosis and malaria.

Mr Speaker, malaria still stands as one of the serious threats to people's lives. Malaria is still a killer disease. Tuberculosis also has a lot of health

consequences that affect many people, and leads to organ problems and organ failures.

Mr Speaker, HIV has now become very rampant, according to the Ministry of Health. Many people in the regions are testing positive to HIV. There is an increase in the number of people who are now testing positive for HIV in Ghana than before.

Mr Speaker, it should be part of the requirements of health screening, in every organisation in Ghana to, either periodically or before one is offered employment, go for HIV test. When one is not tested to know their status, one will be unable to seek solutions to it.

So, Mr Speaker, as much as I support this ratification, I want to just call on every organisation, whether government or non-governmental organisation, that it be a mandatory requirement where, if one is to be engaged in employment or whatsoever, HIV testing be part of it.

Mr Speaker, when one tests positive, medication should be made free; if it is not already, then it should be free everywhere, so that people who test positive can have access.

Mr Speaker, with the concluding part of the Committee's Report, which says that:

“The Committee has carefully considered the agreement and is of the view that, when rectified, it will support government efforts in maintaining and strengthening

Ghana's partnership with the Global Fund, which has played an essential role in providing Ghana's health outcomes, reducing HIV."

2:12 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I do not think the Government is doing enough in reducing HIV in the system. I think the Government has to do more. Government needs to make a lot of resources available in the fight against HIV. As I indicated, it is so terrible that you would be surprised to know that about four out of 10 Ghanaians are testing positive. Now, people are afraid, and they do not even want to get tested. But it should be mandatory. Even if one is at the workplace, there must be yearly medical review and HIV/AIDS testing should be part of it. Tuberculosis tests should also be part of it. Mr Speaker, for those of us from the north, malaria is still a problem. Malaria still remains the number one killer disease when we go up north. People underrate it, but it still kills a lot of people. We should be able to make antimalarial drugs available and affordable, or where possible Government should make it free for our people so that we will be able to fight malaria.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I support the ratification of this Report.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Thank you very much, Hon Members—Yes, Hon Deputy Minister for Finance?

**Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP):** Mr Speaker, I just want to thank Hon Members for speaking in favour of the

ratification of the Agreement for Immunities and Privileges for the Global Fund. The Global Fund currently is one of the last institutions standing that are supporting malaria and HIV in this country. They have been doing this for many years. Doing this ratification will give them the needed morale that they have been looking for to continue to support this country. I am told that so far, they have supported us in excess of US\$900 million, and we are likely to get additional funding that will bring the total support to more than US\$1.1 billion. We really need to do this because it has been long overdue. I am grateful that Hon Members are supporting this cause. Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Consequential Resolution Number 11. Minister for Finance?

**Mr Ampem:** Mr Speaker, I am Deputy Minister for Finance—

**Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I agree with my Brother, because in his absence we sought Mr Speaker's permission to ask the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs to move the Motion. So, we want to seek Mr Speaker's permission to allow the Hon Deputy Minister to take Resolution, that is the item numbered 11 (1) and (2).

I thank you.

**Mr Frank Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, that is progressive! They can move ahead and do it.

## RESOLUTION

### **Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2021)**

**Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP)**  
*on behalf of the Minister for Finance:*  
Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

WHEREAS by the provisions of Article 75 of the Constitution any treaty, agreement, or convention executed by or under the Authority of the President in the name of Ghana is made subject to ratification either by an Act of Parliament or by a resolution of Parliament supported by the votes of more than one-half of all the Members of Parliament.

IN ACCORDANCE with the said Article 75 of the Constitution the President has caused to be laid before Parliament through the Minister responsible for Finance, the Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2011).

NOW THEREFORE, this Honourable House hereby resolves to ratify the said Agreement on Privileges and Immunities of the

Global Fund to Fight AIDS, Tuberculosis and Malaria (2011).

**Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong):** Mr Speaker, I second the Motion.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

*Resolved accordingly.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Majority Leader, any indication?

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I wish that we take Motion number 27. But before then, I pray that we take the *Order Paper Addendum* and lay a couple of Papers before we go back to Motion numbered 27 on the original *Order Paper*. Mr Speaker, if I have the support from my Brother on the other Side, specifically, we are looking at items numbered 1(a), (b), and (c), and then items numbered 2(i), (ii), (iii).

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, at Commencement of Public Business, let us take the item numbered 1 on the *Order Paper Addendum*. Presentation and First Reading. Yes?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, I gladly want to draw the attention of the Majority Chief Whip that the plan is for us to be able to dispose of as much of scheduled businesses as possible so that we can reduce the volume of work, and we can rise on time, so to speak. I want to remind my Colleague again that he should give us a plan—the movement plan. What are the priorities? A while ago, he was on the main *Order Paper*

then he drifted to the *Order Paper Addendum*. I know he has an eye on the *Order Paper* again. So, while I am not objecting to his application, he should conduct Businesses of priority as a whole, so that when we finish laying these items, we can move at the speed of light and get these items done. I am aware the GNPC and the Appropriation Bill, 2025, have been directed to be put on hold for a while. Those ones we can put them on ice. But the ones that we have to do, especially—I see my senior, the Minister for Sports and Recreation, the Bill have to be taken. Let us get the priority Businesses and then we can move with the speed of light.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well, you are right. Probably after laying this Paper, we will go full horse on the other Businesses. Minister for Education, the item numbered 1(a), (b), (b) on the *Order Paper Addendum*. Let us take all of them together.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, the Hon Minister for Education is also unavoidably absent for now. I want to seek your leave to get the Minister for Sports and Recreation to do so on his behalf.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr. Speaker, we will not object, but we must emphasise this point. I am sure the printing of these *Order Papers* were not suddenly done. There was some form of communication, and the Minister for Education must have been informed. He is a dutiful Member of Parliament; He comes. But they should be prepared because he will come under Standing

Order 97(3). If they are fully fortified to comply, then they can go ahead.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Chief Whip, do not threaten your Brother.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** The Minister was my senior. We attended a common secondary school, Bishop Herman Senior High School. He was my senior at school. I respect him. I would never—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** He did not punish you, so why are you trying to punish him?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, that one, you do not have it for certain. I went through a number of treatments from his hands, but that is for another day. So, we are not objecting.

Are they ready to speak to the Papers? If they are not ready, we can—

2:22 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Minister for Sports and Recreation on behalf of the Minister for Education. The item numbered 1 on the *Order Paper Addendum*, (a), (b) and (c) together.

## BILLS — FIRST READING

### **Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies (Amendment) Bill, 2025**

AN ACT to amend the Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies Act,



2019, Act 1001, to change the name of the university to the University of Business and Integrated Development Studies and to provide for related matters.

*Presented by the Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams) on behalf of the Minister for Education. Read the First Time; referred to the Committee on Education.*

**C.K. Tadam University of Technology and Applied Sciences (Amendment) Bill, 2025**

AN ACT to amend the C. K. Tadam University of Technology and Applied Sciences Act, 2019, Act 1000, to change the name of the university to the University of Technology and Applied Sciences and to provide for related matters.

*Presented by the Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams) on behalf of the Minister for Education. Read the First Time; referred to the Committee on Education.*

**Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development (Amendment) Bill, 2025**

AN ACT to amend the Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development Act 2020, Act 1026, to change the name of the university to the University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development and to provide for related matters.

*Presented by the Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams) on behalf of the Minister for Education. Read the First Time; referred to the Committee on Education.*

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, may we take the item numbered 2 on the *Order Paper Addendum* to lay the Reports (i) to (iii).

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** I have just referred the matter to the Committee for consideration and Reports. Therefore, immediately after, we cannot take the Reports. So, let the Committee get their Reports ready and I will do the needful.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, may I take you respectfully back to the *Order Paper* so that we take the item numbered 8 (i) and (ii), before we can take the Motion numbered 27.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Item numbered 8 (i).

**PAPERS**

*By the Chairperson of the Committee*

Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the determination of the urgency of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, may I pray that we take Motion numbered 27

because the Reports are ready. It has been floated onto the console, that is the electronic copy.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, we can proceed.

## MOTION

### Determination of Urgency, Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025

**Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams):** Thank you Mr Speaker. I beg to *move*:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports on the determination of the urgency of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

**Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Ernest Henry Norgbey):** Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to second the Motion. Mr Speaker, your Committee met on the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 to first of all determine the urgency of the Bill. We spoke to the Ministry and all the relevant stakeholders. Mr Speaker, I urge the *Hansard* Department to capture this very Report as it seems to have been read in its entirety whilst I take you to the conclusion of the Report.

### Introduction

The Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 was laid in Parliament on Wednesday, 17<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation, Mr Kofi Iddie Adams, and read the First

time. The Rt Hon Speaker referred the Bill to the Committee on Youth and Sports for consideration and report.

The Rt Hon Speaker further directed the Committee to determine whether the Bill was of an urgent nature, and should be taken through all the stages in one day in accordance with article 106(13) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 160 of the Standing Orders of Parliament.

The Committee, having regard to the referral made by the Rt Hon Speaker, met with the Hon Minister responsible for Sports and Recreation and officials of the Ministry on Thursday, 18<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 to determine the urgency of the Bill.

### Reference Documents

The Committee made reference to the following documents during its deliberations:

- i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992.
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament, 2024.
- iii. The Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

### Observations/Recommendations

Establishment and Operationalisation of the Fund Prior to the 2026 World Cup Tournament

The Committee noted that the upcoming 2026 World Cup Tournament

to be held in the United States of America, Canada and Mexico provides an important platform, which could be leveraged on to fully operationalise the Ghana Sports Fund and attract substantial publicity and investments to the Fund. Establishing the Fund promptly would, therefore, maximise resource mobilisation efforts to adequately support the sports sector.

The Committee observed further that establishment of the Ghana Sports Fund was overdue, particularly given the persistent inadequate funding of sporting disciplines, which limits Ghana's participation in international tournaments and stalls the development of sports in the country. To salvage this chronic underfunding challenge, the sporting sector relies heavily on donations and sponsorship from philanthropists and corporate organisations. The funds realised from such support are managed under ad hoc and uncoordinated arrangements, which impede the institutionalisation of proper accountability and transparency mechanisms. This situation discourages potential investors and philanthropists from committing funds for the development of sports in the country.

To this end, the establishment of the Fund as soon as practicable would facilitate the institutionalisation of relevant structures and the full operationalisation of the Fund prior to the 2026 World Cup Tournament. This is a critical step, given the significant boost that the qualification and participation of the Black Stars in the tournament would

provide for fundraising efforts for the Fund.

A fully established and operationalised Fund during the first quarter of the year 2026 would attract significant investments and donations, particularly as the upcoming Tournament provides a global platform to market the Fund and the Ghanaian sports industry at no cost to the State. The Ministry intends to leverage on the exposure and opportunities to be provided by international media houses including the Cable News Network (CNN), the British Broadcasting Corporation (BBC) and Aljazeera to market the Fund to a broader world audience.

Accordingly, enacting the Sports Fund Bill under a certificate of urgency would provide a legal basis for the swift establishment of the Fund and the appointment of the relevant human resource to fully operationalise the Fund prior to the World Cup Tournament. A fully operational Fund would create a centralised entity that would coordinate and manage proceeds from funding sources, thereby restoring investor and financier confidence in the sports sector.

The Committee recommends strongly, therefore, that the Bill be considered under a certificate of urgency to enable the sports sector leverage on opportunities and platforms provided by the upcoming World Cup Tournament to

secure significant funding for the Ghana Sports Fund.

### **Stakeholder Consultations on the Bill**

The Hon Minister informed the Committee that relevant stakeholders in the sports sector have been variously engaged during the drafting of the Bill, particularly as the concept of establishing a dedicated Fund for the sector has been in contemplation for a considerable period of time. The Committee was informed that the Ghana Olympic Committee and the leadership of various sports federations had been extensively consulted on provisions of the Bill. The Ministry had also held media engagements on the Bill and solicited inputs from stakeholders prior to the formulation of the Bill.

In order to ensure that the Bill appropriately represents the interests of relevant stakeholders, particularly as relates to sources of money for the Fund, the Committee has further engaged the Ministry of Finance, the National Lottery Authority, the National Sports Authority and the Food and Drugs Authority for further deliberations.

Accordingly, the Committee is of the considered view that passing the Bill under a certificate of urgency would not deprive key stakeholders the opportunity to contribute to the provisions of the Bill, and the interests of relevant groups have been considered and incorporated into the draft legislation.

The Committee, therefore, recommends the enactment of the Bill into law, as soon as practicable, in furtherance of the objective of securing sustainable funding for the sports sector.

### **Conclusion**

In light of the underfunding challenges afflicting the sports sector and the limited timeframe for the establishment of the Fund to enable Ghana benefit from the various opportunities the 2026 World Cup Tournament would provide in respect of attracting proceeds for the Fund, there is no better time than now to take decisive action by passing the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 into law. The Committee strongly believes that taking the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 under a certificate of urgency is justified, and we urge prompt consideration and passage of this critical legislation.

The Committee, therefore, recommends that given the wide stakeholder consultations undertaken prior to the formulation of the Bill and having regard to the enormous benefits that would accrue with the expeditious passage of the Bill, the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 be considered under a certificate of urgency to facilitate the operationalisation of the Fund for the benefit of Ghanaians.

Upon fully determining the urgency of the Bill, the Committee realised that the underfunding challenges afflicting the sports sector and the limited timeframe for the establishment of the fund, to enable Ghana benefit from the various opportunities the 2026 World

Cup tournament will provide, in respect of attracting proceeds for the fund.

There is no better time than now to take decisive action by passing the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 into law. The Committee strongly believes that taking the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 under a certificate of urgency is justified and we urge prompt consideration and passage of this critical legislation.

The Committee therefore recommends that given the wide stakeholder consultation undertaken, prior to the formulation of the Bill, and having regard to the enormous benefits that will accrue with the expeditious passage of the Bill the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 be considered under a certificate of urgency to facilitate the operationalisation of the fund for the benefit of Ghana. Respectfully submitted.

*Question proposed.*

**Mr Dickson Kyere-Duah (NDC — Berekum West):** Thank you very much, Mr Speaker. I rise to support the passage of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025. In so doing, I would like to elucidate some of the important reasons for this House to support the passage of this Bill, which will eventually become the game changer in terms of sports development. It will also use sports as a very powerful socio-economic vehicle for the development of this nation.

Mr Speaker, we all know Ghana is a powerhouse when we talk about continental sports. Yet years of

underfunding and lack of investment is now bringing Ghana backwards. It is therefore important that this Bill, which seeks to provide sustainable funding for the development of sports, as well as provide for sports to be used as a vehicle for the development of this country, be supported.

2:30 p.m.

Mr Speaker, as a result of the lack investment, we all saw the embarrassment Ghana suffered in 2024 when we got to a point that none of our national facilities in this country, Tamale, Kumasi, Takoradi, and Accra was fit to host our Cup of Nations qualifiers. We had to run to our neighbours, Togo, for reprieve. They rejected us. It took last-minute maneuvering and diplomatic intervention to get CAF to grant us access to Accra Sports Stadium.

Mr Speaker, here we are, preparing for the 2026 World Cup. Once again, funding is the most important challenge militating against the forward march of the country. It is therefore important that, as a country, we have a mechanism to get sustainable funding once and for all. Over the years, sports funding has been under the central government and we all know the central government alone cannot do that.

Mr Speaker, when GETFund was introduced, there was initial resistance. Today, we know the role GETFund is providing in terms of sustainable funding for education. When the National Health Insurance Fund came, we knew the role the Fund has played over the years. So,

when we get the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025, passed and we get sustainable funding, there will be an opportunity for all sectors in the country to get their fair share of the infrastructure development.

Again, Mr Speaker, over the years, when we talk about sports, it has been limited to the development of football infrastructure. This is a one-in-a-million opportunity to get funding to develop all aspects of sports.

Mr Speaker, let me conclude by using my beloved Region, Bono Ahafo, as a case study. Bono Region is the epicentre of football in Ghana. In 1963, when we won the African Cup of Nations, the lives of Atta Kwame and others were there. Nana Agyeman-Badu was once a pillar of the Black Stars. Kwesi Owusu was the captain of Black Stars. We can talk about Goerge Arthur. The first U-17 World Cup that we won, the captain of the team, Alex Opoku, was from the Bono Region, and the likes of Awudu Issaka. In the U-20 World Cup, we won the last kick by Agyemang-Badu from Seikwa. Bono Region has contributed so much to the development of this country, yet we cannot boast of the needed and modern infrastructure for the development. So once this Bill is passed, we have sustainable funding, coupled with the aggressive infrastructure, H.E John Dramani Mahama is pursuing in the area of sports.

Mr Speaker, for our information, this year, 2026, three modern stadia are going to be built. In 2027 and 2028, an additional five stadia would be built. So, with the support of the Bill, sustainable

funding would come in, and I am very confident that Bono's regional capital, Sunyani, will get a modern stadium that befits the status of the region as the epicentre of football in Ghana.

Mr Speaker, on that note, I want to appeal to this House to rally behind this Bill and pass it as a matter of urgency. Mr Speaker, this is a golden opportunity as we prepare for the World Cup in the U.S.A., Canada and Mexico. The corporate world has the appetite to contribute to the development of football and sports in general, and that platform will give us a huge leverage to market the Ghana Sports Fund, by then to the world, to attract people to invest into the fund for the development of sports.

It is therefore important that this Bill is considered under the certificate of urgency to be passed to put the Bill into operation for the World Cup 2026. Mr Speaker, I support this Bill and thank you for indulging me.

**Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (NPP — Old Tafo):** Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to comment on the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports to determine the urgency of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, it is clear that in this country, as we speak, when it comes to resources that are supposed to be used to fund our sporting activities, we do not need a soothsayer to tell us that we have a huge challenge. Mr Speaker, let me bring your mind to the Ghana Premier League. As we speak, it is one of the most unattractive sporting activities in

Africa. The growing unattractiveness is because of lack of funding.

Today, in this room, if we ask ourselves how many of us can mention about six football clubs that play in the Ghana Premier League, it is going to be very difficult for us to mention six of them. This is because funding that is supposed to be available to be able to boost morale in terms of the Ghana Premier League is unavailable. It is on that basis that we believe that we need to pass this Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025, urgently, to make resources available for our football fraternity.

Mr Speaker, secondly, it is important to note that as part of our considerations, we realised that we need to support our sporting activities by identifying clear strategies to bring some amount of money to the pool. In so doing, the Committee realised that at every point in time when Ghana has an opportunity to be able to partake in competitions or tournaments like the World Cup, there are proceeds that are given to the state to develop local sports. And so, it is important that we fully direct all those resources that are given to the state to be able to support the Sports Fund.

Mr Speaker, one of the critical things that we also realised was that before now, advertisements for our local sports activities and even sometimes international was hugely done by beverage companies. As we speak, there have been guidelines from the Food and Drugs Authority (FDA) that limit the capacity in terms of these beverage

companies to be able to support our sporting activities. The Committee realised that it is one of the huge reasons our sporting activities are not doing well. We also realised that it is going to be one of the strategies to generate some amount of resources to the sports fund. We believe that it is urgent for us to be able to pass this Bill so that our sporting activities would do well as expected.

Mr Speaker, thank you very much for contributing.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, I want to make some corrections at this level. It is rather the Motion numbered 25, so the Chairman was right in seconding the Motion. We are now determining the urgency or otherwise. Hon Members, I will put a question.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

*Resolved accordingly.*

2:42 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** We move on to the Motion numbered 27, if the Report of the Committee is ready.

**Mr Norgbey:** Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to present the Report of the Committee.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** No, the Motion must be moved by the Minister for Sports and Recreation again.

## BILL — SECOND READING

### Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025

**Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams):** Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, I said so because, having determined the urgency or otherwise of the Bill, there will be no need to move the procedural Motion numbered 26.

Chairperson of the Committee, you may now present the Report of the Committee at Second Reading.

**Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Ernest Henry Norgbey):** Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to support the Motion and in doing, present the Report of the Committee on the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

Mr Speaker, I urge *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as having been read while I take you to paragraph 7, observations and recommendations.

### Introduction

The Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 was laid in Parliament on Wednesday, 17<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 by the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation, Mr Kofi Iddie Adams, in accordance with article 106(1) of the 1992 Constitution.

Pursuant to article 106(4) of the 1992 Constitution and the Standing Orders of Parliament, the Speaker subsequently referred the Bill to the Committee on Youth and Sports for consideration and report.

### Deliberations

The Committee met with the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation and Officials of the Ministry on Thursday, 18<sup>th</sup> December, 2025 to consider the Bill. The Committee was assisted in its deliberations by officials of the Office of the Attorney-General and Ministry of Justice.

The Committee expresses profound gratitude to the Hon Minister and other stakeholders for attending upon it, and providing assistance during its deliberations.

### Reference Documents

The Committee referred to the following documents during the deliberations:

- i. The Constitution of the Republic of Ghana, 1992;
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament, 2024;
- iii. The Interpretation Act, 2009 (Act 792);
- iv. The Sports Act, 2016 (Act 934);



- v. The Gaming Act, 2006 (Act 721);
- vi. The Public Financial Management Act, 2016 (Act 921);
- vii. The National Lotto Act, 2006 (Act 722); and
- viii. The Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025.

## **Background**

The Government of Ghana, as part of efforts to bridge existing gaps in sports financing, seeks to introduce a system to provide sustainable funding for sports development in the country and sports for development through the establishment of the Ghana Sports Fund. The Fund seeks to provide adequate funds for sports development, as well as facilitate transparency and accountability in resource mobilisation and management in the sports sector.

The Government recognises the inadequacy of central budgetary support and occasional philanthropic sponsorship in fulfilling the needs and demands of stakeholders and beneficiaries in the sports sector. There is also the absence of a permanent centralised entity to receive and manage funds donated by philanthropists and sponsors for the development of various sporting disciplines. This situation, therefore, impedes transparency and accountability for donations made for sports development in the country.

Accordingly, proceeds of the Fund would cater for the development of sporting infrastructure; facilitate capacity building for sports professionals and administrators; support the development of grassroots sports and school sports through identification of talent and nurturing programmes; and support the participation of national teams and athletes in international competitions, among others.

The Fund would be governed by a Board, who would oversee administration of proceeds to be drawn from financing sources including government budgetary provisions, earnings from special sports lotteries, a percentage of financial gains from competitions and tournaments, as well as philanthropic support, among others.

The Bill, therefore, seeks to provide a legislative framework for the Ghana Sports Fund and set out arrangements for the management of the Fund.

## **Purpose of the Bill**

The Bill seeks to establish the Ghana Sports Fund to mobilise resources to provide sustainable funding for sports development in the country and sport for development, as well as provide for the management of the Fund.

## **Summary of Provisions of the Bill**

The Bill contains a total of 34 clauses.

Clauses 1 to 5 of the Bill set out the legal and operational basis for the Ghana Sports Fund.

Clauses 6 to 14 of the Bill provide for the governance of the Fund, which includes an eleven-member Board as the governing body of the Fund.

Clauses 15 to 22 deal with the administration of the Fund, including the establishment of a secretariat, and the appointment of the Administrator of the Fund and other staff.

Clauses 23 to 26 relate to financial provisions including expenses of the Fund and exemptions from the payment of taxes.

Clauses 27 to 29 provide for beneficiaries and services under the Fund, which include eligibility criteria and application procedure.

Clause 30 outlines a redress mechanism for persons aggrieved by decisions of the Fund.

Clauses 31 to 34 cover miscellaneous provisions, including collaboration between the Fund and the National Lottery Authority to organise special sports lotteries for sports development in the country.

Clauses 32 to 34 provide for the making of Regulations by the Hon Minister, interpretation of words and phrases used in the Bill, as well as consequential amendments.

## **Observations and Recommendations**

The Committee made the following observations and recommendations during the deliberations:

### **Need for Dedicated Sports Funding**

The Committee agreed that the sports sector of the country faced underfunding challenges as a result of overreliance on annual budgetary allocations to the Ministry. This has occasioned the abandonment of some sporting disciplines; lack of sufficient funding for consistent participation in tournaments; inability to maintain and provide requisite infrastructure; and welfare challenges particularly for retired and injured athletes. The situation is further compounded by dwindling donations and financial assistance from the private sector due to the absence of a sustainable structure for the management of such funds.

The Committee, therefore, considers the establishment of a dedicated Fund as a laudable step to improve the development of sports in Ghana and enhance the nation's visibility on international sports platforms.

### **Sources of Funding**

The Committee noted that the sources of money for the Fund include moneys approved by Parliament, proceeds derived from special sports lotteries, 10 per cent of fees and charges accruing from the Gaming Commission of Ghana from sports betting companies,

as well as percentages of proceeds from tournaments and bonuses for athletes.

The Committee observed, however, that apart from moneys approved by Parliament and the 10 per cent of fees and charges accruing to the Gaming Commission of Ghana, which may be considered major sustainable sources of money for the Fund, other sources such as percentages of gate proceeds and bonuses did not guarantee sustainable earnings for the Fund.

The Committee, therefore, welcomed the dedication of 10 per cent of the total cost of advertisements by beverage producing companies as a reliable source to attract significant financial inflows to the Fund.

### **Review of Guidelines on Alcoholic Beverage Advertisements During Sports Activities**

The Committee is of the considered view that a review of restrictions by the Food and Drugs Authority on alcoholic beverage advertisements during sports activities, in Guideline Number FDA/FID/GL-AD/2016/01, would attract sponsorship and shore up resources for the Sports Fund.

The Ministry of Sports and Recreation indicated that the restriction by the Food and Drugs Authority on alcohol advertising during sporting events has reduced sponsorship opportunities and diminished the vibrancy of the local league, ultimately affecting the financing of national teams. It was further noted, however, that

alcoholic products are advertised during foreign tournaments, and many young people regularly watch these sports programmes on Digital Satellite Television and other global platforms.

The Committee earlier convened a meeting with the Hon Minister for Health and representatives of the Food and Drugs Authority on implementation of the provisions of the guidelines, which restrict advertisements by alcoholic beverage companies during sports activities. The Authority reiterated the adverse health implications of excessive alcohol consumption and the tendency for such practices to increase, particularly among the youth, if the restrictions were reviewed.

The Committee is mindful of the need to create a fair balance between addressing public health concerns and boosting national economic benefits and the development of sports. The Committee, therefore, concurs with the Ministry of Sports and Recreation that a review of the existing guidelines is necessary to enhance sponsorship opportunities for sports activities and the accrual of monies for the Fund to the benefit of grassroots sports, local leagues and national teams. This recommendation is particularly in light of the fact that minors are exposed to advertisements of alcoholic beverages on the worldwide web and other foreign sports viewing platforms, despite the measures instituted by the Food and Drugs Authority.

The Committee recommends further that the Food and Drugs Authority could

review the restrictions to allow alcoholic beverage companies to advertise their products during sporting activities, with the caveat that athletes and other renowned public figures would caution against alcohol abuse and emphasise the appropriate age limits during such advertisements. This approach could promote responsible alcohol usage without stifling proceeds from alcoholic beverage advertisements.

### **Streamlining Operational Costs**

The Committee cautioned the Ministry against the establishment of a Fund that is overburdened by costs associated with administrative and non-core functions. The advice is in order to safeguard sports-centred outcomes and prevent diversion of resources away from central objectives of the Fund. It recommended, therefore, that the Fund be managed by a streamlined secretariat and governed by a transparent financial framework to minimise operational overheads.

The Committee accordingly recommends the early composition of the eleven-member governing body of the Fund, which comprises key functionaries with relevant experience and expertise, to oversee the prudent management of the Fund and ensure significant returns on investment.

### **Leverage on Subsidiary Legislation for Full Operationalisation of Statute**

The Committee encouraged the Ministry to submit the relevant subsidiary legislation to Parliament

shortly after the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 is enacted into law to clarify operational details and aid full operationalisation of the policy underpinnings of the primary legislation. This would ensure that Ghana reaps optimum dividends from the Fund, and the objective of accountability and transparency in sports financing would be achieved.

### **Proposed Amendment**

The Committee proposed the underlisted amendment during its consideration of the Bill:

Clause 3-Amendment proposed-Subclause (j) *delete* and *insert*: “ten per cent of the total cost of advertisement of beverages”.

### **Conclusion**

The Committee acknowledges the funding challenges in the sports sector of the country, and the negative impact the situation has on sports development generally. It is necessary, therefore, that measures are instituted to address gaps in financing the sector to favourably position our country to tap into the expanding global sports revenue pool for the wellbeing of the Ghanaian populace.

Having carefully examined the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt its Report and approve the enactment of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 in accordance with article 106(1) of the 1992 Constitution.

Respectfully submitted.

*Question proposed.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Adama Sulemana, you have the floor.

**Mr Adama Sulemana (NDC — Tain):** Thank you, Mr Speaker. I rise to contribute to the Report from the Committee on Youth and Sports on the establishment of the Ghana Sports Fund.

Mr Speaker, the Committee observed that activities of the Gaming Commission are largely through sports betting and that previously, the Gaming Commission contributed nothing to sports. As a result, it is the view of the Committee that there be resources from the Gaming Commission to support the development of sports and that 10 per cent of fees and charges of the Gaming Commission be dedicated to the Sports Fund.

Mr Speaker, the Committee also observed that funds have been established but we may see situations where a larger chunk of the fund is used for administrative purposes. So, the Committee cautioned that in the establishment of this Fund, a lot of the resources be channelled towards sports-centered outcomes rather than operations of the Fund.

Mr Speaker, another source of funds that the Committee looked at was advertisement of beverages. The Committee observed that in order to operationalise this portion of the Bill, Food and Drugs Authority (FDA)

regulations that forbid advertisement of alcoholic beverages at sports arenas be looked at and that 10 per cent of advertisement costs be also dedicated to this Fund.

Mr Speaker, I therefore, call on this House to support this Bill in order to provide the needed infrastructure, support to the welfare of athletes both now and in the future, and also generally to uplift the image of sports in the country. I therefore support the adoption of the Report of the Committee and urge the House to pass the Bill.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Assafuah?

**Mr Vincent Ekow Assafuah (NPP — Old Tafo):** Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity to contribute to the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports.

Mr Speaker, your Committee met and we discussed the relevance of establishing a Sports Fund and in so doing, we discussed the relevance of having this Bill to be able to support our sporting activities. We identified a number of sources of funds because previously, the sources of funds which are dedicated to our sporting activities have always been moneys that are determined from the State to be given to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation. It has always been the case that this House will approve some amounts of moneys to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation,

but unfortunately, even releases have been a problem.

During the year under review, the year 2025, this House approved moneys to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation but the Committee realised that releases were not up to the point that we were expecting that the Ministry could have been able to get. And so, we realised that the identification of these sources will be able to support our sporting activities. Key among them was the fact that proceeds that are derived from special sports lotteries be one of the important sources of funds for the Sports Fund Bill.

2:52 p.m.

We also realised that it is important to have 10 per cent of the revenue of tax derived by the gaming commission from sports betting companies. The Committee also identified that 5 per cent of gate proceeds from sports activities could be a major source of funding for the Sports Fund Bill. One of the sources was also 3 per cent of proceeds derived from the transfer of athletes within and outside the country. We also identified 10 per cent of proceeds derived from sports competitions and tournaments.

The Committee also realised that because these are moneys that are not from the state or from people from within, it is important that we give all those moneys to the Sports Fund to be able to support them. I remember in 2010, when we went to the South African World Cup, the State was interested in the money allocated to develop local

football. Unfortunately, those moneys were not given to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation to work. The Committee realised that, going forward, any time this country participates in a tournament or competition, money from these competitions should be fully given to the Sports Fund to support our local sporting activities.

We also identified moneys that accrue to the Fund from investment. The Committee identified that grants, donations, gifts, and any other voluntary contributions that are made to the Fund is also one of the most important sources of funds for the Fund. So, Mr Speaker, it is clear that how we used to manage our sporting activities in this country in terms of funding has not always been the best. It is on that basis that the Committee decided to enumerate these sources of funds in the Bill so that, going forward, this House will approve them for the betterment of our sporting activities in this country.

With these few words, I thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the Report.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib.

**Second Deputy Minority Whip (Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib):** Mr Speaker, I thank you sincerely for giving me this opportunity.

Mr Speaker, I start by saying that the sports in Ghana have a multidimensional problem. It is multidimensional because, at every angle, we face a different

problem. I am the President of the Ghana Weightlifting Federation, and I have also had the opportunity to study Sports Management at the Master's level at the University of Ottawa. Fortunately, my thesis was on the funding gap of sports in Ghana, and the Ghana Olympics Committee was in perspective.

Mr Speaker, I was actually the Deputy Secretary General of the Ghana Olympics Committee. So, I speak with a lot of experience.

First of all, let us talk about the budget allocation. The Minister will tell you that the budget allocation is virtually non-existent because the amount of money that is sent to the Ministry of Sports and Recreation is as if no money has been sent. And when the money is allocated, the releases even become a problem. What happens is that in Ghana, there is a larger focus on one major sport, to the total neglect of the other ones, which they call the lesser-known sports. The former Minister for Sports is very much aware of what I am talking about. There is a lot of attention on football. What happens to even football? All they do is give the Ghanaian people broken hearts.

Mr Speaker, the amount of money allocated to football at the neglect of the other sports is sad. I organised the Weightlifting Federation of Africa Youth Championship. The Minister for Sports and Recreation is here; they did not give 1 cedi. The Government of Ghana did not get 1 cedi to sponsor that project. But let them say that they are going to play *mo ntse ndi* behind

Parliament, you will see the amount of money that will be lifted to support football.

Mr Speaker, it is critical to also look at the other aspects of sports. That has become a problem. Let us be advised, as Members of Parliament, that sports should be non-partisan. I won an election as the President of the Ghana Weightlifting Federation. The moment power changed, we had people coming to remove me from my position forcefully. It is the same even with football. When we do well with football, it is tagged to a political party. Which football competition has one ever gone through to play just one game and qualified for the World Cup? It is a process. But in Ghana, even a change in power politicises politics.

Mr Speaker, let me deal with the issues of the funding. I have also heard from my Colleagues that some funding will come from athletes who will be abroad, but are Ghanaian. Where are they going to get the money from? There are weightlifters who are from the diaspora. I sometimes have to purchase tickets for them to attend and perform for Mother Ghana. And we are intending to take money from them. Where are we taking the money from?

Mr Speaker, the reality with sports is that we need to be more careful how we deal with all of this—For example, resource allocation. Now, when it comes to infrastructure, the Minister for Sports and Recreation will say he is doing his best. But even for sporting activities, infrastructure is virtually non-existent.

As I stand here today, we are in Angola for the youth games. The Weightlifting Federation had to be the one to export our weightlifting equipment to Angola to support their competition there. It means that if Ghana supports our athletes, our sports, and our sporting activities, we will be the beneficiaries of any victories they achieve. But what are we seeing? The usual things we see are that a party is in power, and this person is not a product of this party. So, we are going to frustrate him more.

How do we even get moneys which will be constant, which will be stable, which will be properly mapped out for the training of talents? Mr Speaker, that is virtually non-existent. I have seen the list of sources. He says that the sources of funding will be derived from special sports lotteries. Are we looking at betting? Is there also a way to redirect the betting tax?

3:02 p.m.

Are we being real with this? If it is the betting tax, we should say so. Because it says that 10 per cent of fees and charges accruing from the Gaming Commission. It then goes on to even say that from sports betting companies.

Mr Speaker, the value is just the same. It also goes on to say that percentages from tournaments and bonuses from athletes, how? This is not a reliable way of generating funds for our athletes. If we go to the Accra Sports Stadium when Kumasi Asante Kotoko and Accra Hearts of Oak are playing a game, and the fees that are taken at the

gates is beyond GH¢100.00, there would be an empty park. The structures from which they even collect the money, people end up pocketing those moneys, and tickets that are produced and supposed to be accounted for are not accounted for by the end of the day. We should find a more upgraded way, have proper structures and use proper computerised forms. Respectfully, let us take human beings from running sports stadia. The National Sports Authority (NSA) is virtually moribund. What they do is that they give the sports stadium for entertainment activities. I have heard one that is going to happen on the 21<sup>st</sup> and they will end up messing up the place and come and take money to say that they are going to refit the place.

Mr Speaker, I believe that we should move away from weaker policies and look at reliable sources of funding. They cannot say that athletes or footballers should go and struggle and bring the money or the bonus that they have had to contribute towards sports development. It would not happen.

Mr Speaker, with all this said, I conclude by praying that we will re-look at all of this and see the best way to develop our sports and it should be developed from an angle of a non-partisan basis. We do not have a National Democratic Congress (NDC) Black Stars, nor do we have a New Patriotic Party (NPP) Black Stars.

Mr Speaker, with this, I thank you for giving me this opportunity



**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, I intend to put the Question.

Yes, Hon First Deputy Minority Whip?

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, our Leadership would like to yield to the immediate past Minister for Youth and Sports.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Mustapha Ussif, you have the floor.

**Mr Mustapha Ussif:** Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to also make comments on the Report of the Committee on Youth and Sports for the establishment of the Ghana Sports Fund.

Mr Speaker, the biggest challenge for the sports sector is funding and the reason it is so is that at the Ministry of Sports and Recreation or the sports sector, we have various federations. When I was there, these federations were more than 50 and all these federations have their national assignments that they do, that are national competitions. So, for example, apart from the well-known federations like the Ghana Football Association (GFA), the Ghana Boxing Authority (GBA) and the Boxing Association, the Swimming Association or the Aquatic and the Ghana Weightlifting, we have other associations or federations called fencing and all these associations have national teams. Anytime these national teams have national games, they have to prepare themselves very well so that they can compete to win medals. Apart from these national games, they also have

international assignments and in the international assignments, they mostly have to prepare so that when they go to the international level, they will be able to represent us very well and lift our flag high. This is because any time they are representing Ghana, they are going to represent our flag and that is why before they go, it is important that they prepare very well. This all boils down to money.

Because of lack of resources, most Ministers—I know my Senior, Hon Ayariga, has been at the Ministry of Sports before, which mostly relies on only football. Even when it comes to football, it is only the Black Stars that would normally get funding. Because even within the football ecosystem, we have the junior Under-17 national team, Under-20 national team, Under-23 national team and the senior national team, both male and female and the local Black Stars. All of these teams have to compete internationally and any time they are going to compete, there is a huge challenge with funding. Because it is important, when I was there as a sector Minister, I initiated this process that my successor is working on for us to be able to establish it and that is why I support the call that we should establish this Sports Fund.

Mr Speaker, I took a trip to Morocco in the process of making sure that we bring this Sports Fund and the sports lotteries was one of the areas or the good initiative that the Moroccan Government — that is why Morocco is now doing very well. They have established sports lotteries and it is specialised lotteries that is established to ensure that the proceeds

that come from this lottery is used not only for football but all other federations. I am very sure that when this Sports Fund Bill is passed and we manage it judiciously, our national teams from all the federations will start doing well.

Mr Speaker, apart from participating in international events, we have challenges that have to do with facilities and infrastructure. Most of these federations find it very difficult getting equipment not to talk of even facilities. We only had to leverage on the African Games we hosted last year to ensure that we got most of this equipment for these national teams. That is why we see that most of them are now even performing. Because now they have equipment to train with and represent us very well.

Mr Speaker, the sources of funding indicated in the Report apart from the budgetary allocation — we all know that in this country that, when it comes to budgetary allocation, the releases is a problem. The most reliable one that I can say is the sports lotteries and I want to appeal to the Minister for Sports and Recreation to ensure that they work very well with the National Lotteries Authority (NLA) so that they find an innovative way of making sure that there would be a lot of proceeds that will be coming through that channel. Aside that, he cannot rely on the players. Like Hon Jerry Ahmed Shaib said, most of these international athletes in the other countries, even though they are professionals, still rely on Ghana even for their preparation. They would still write or call for the country to sponsor them to be able to come. This is because

some of them are students who represent us. So, apart from the footballers, it is very difficult to get money from the rest.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I want to support this initiative and wish my successor very well in the process of getting this Sports Fund to come into fruition.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Thank you very much, Hon Members.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

The Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 is accordingly read a Second time.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I pray that we take item numbered 9(b) on the original *Order Paper*. Let me further pray that the Minister for Finance and his Deputy are unavoidably absent, so we want to pray that the Minister for Education to do so on his behalf.

Mr Speaker, thank you.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, the item numbered 9 (b).

3:12 p.m.

## **BILL — FIRST READING**

### **The Appropriation Bill, 2025**

AN ACT to provide for the withdrawal of sums of money necessary to meet government expenditure for the 2026 financial year from the Consolidated Fund and other public funds and for related matters.

*Referred to the Budget Committee.*

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, we want to take the Motion numbered 23, which was advertised in the original *Order Paper*—

Mr Speaker, I pray that we defer this and take the items numbered 1 and 2 on the *Order Paper Addendum 2*. We want to lay that Bill, and then take the item numbered 2 on the *Order Paper Addendum 2*.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, at the commencement of Public Business, Presentation of Papers, item numbered 1 on *Order Paper Addendum 2*.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I pray that in the absence of the Hon Minister for Finance, the Hon Minister for Education should do this on his behalf.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, the application is that the Paper be presented by the Hon Minister for Education.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, we are not opposed.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minister for Education, you have the floor.

## PAPER

*By the Minister for Education (Mr Haruna Iddrisu) on behalf of the Minister for Finance*

An act to establish the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority to encourage, promote, facilitate and regulate investments into and within Ghana to provide for the creation of an incentive framework and a transparent, predictable and facilitating environment for investment in Ghana. To facilitate investments outside Ghana by Ghanaian investors in Ghana and to provide for related matters.

*Referred to the Finance Committee.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 at the Consideration Stage.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, I pray that the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority (GIPC) Bill, which you referred, if you have no objection, and the leadership will accept same, can you add the Leadership of the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism to support?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well, I will ask that the Leadership of the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism to join the Budget Committee.

Hon Members, we are at the Consideration Stage; all other Hon Members standing should humbly resume their seats, particularly those who are turning their back against the mace.

## BILL — CONSIDERATION STAGE

### Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025

Clause 1 and 2 ordered to stand part of the Bill

Clause 3 — Sources of monies for the Fund.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Chairman of the Committee?

**Chairman of the Committee (Mr Ernest Henry Norgbey):** Mr Speaker, I beg to move that in clause 3, paragraph j, we *delete* and *insert* “10 per cent of the total cost of the advertisement of beverages”.

I so submit, Mr Speaker.

Amendment ordered to stand part of the Bill

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, I am to do a reverse gear to consider clause 3. So, I am back to clause 3.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, clause 3, with your leave, and I see the sponsor of the Bill, the Hon Minister for Sports.

Mr Speaker, a popular way of raising revenue for sports and recreation development— First of all, I want to appeal to the Chairman and the Hon Minister, wherever we have “Sports”, if we do not have objection, it should be “Sports and Recreation”. That is now the new nomenclature. It is not just Sports.

Mr Speaker, I just want to add that part of the source of funds should be the sale of sports memorabilia. If they have no objection, they should just add it. For instance, if we print out the jersey for Black Stars 2026, and we spend US\$10, the sale of sports memorabilia can be a huge source of funding for them. If it is to get somebody to negotiate with and sell the franchise to, so we can print a jersey for Ghana at the World Cup 2026—If we spend US\$10 and sell it for US\$15, less overhead, it can generate some money for the fund.

I so submit, Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, Hon Minister for Education, what is your rendition?

4:32 p.m.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, add a new subclause to read, “Sales and returns from sports memorabilia.”

Amendment ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 3 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 4 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 5 — Application of moneys of the Fund.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, with your indulgence, clause 5(a) reads, ‘...promote the development of

infrastructure required for the training of athletes.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member let us take the Chairperson's amendment. If there is no amendment to clause 5, then I will give you the floor to propose your amendment.

**Dr Norgbey:** Mr Speaker, no advertised amendment.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Now, I can hear you.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker is strict on his procedure and rules; appreciated. Mr Speaker, I am just asking for a wider definition of athletes. In everyday language athlete will refer to those doing tracks. That is why I say I want an explanation. When we say training of athletes, it can be narrowed. When we are developing infrastructure required for the training of athletes, organisation of tournament and participation in sports—Participation in sports what? I just want an explanation from the sponsor or the Chairperson. Thank you.

**Mr Kofi Iddie Adams:** Mr Speaker, athletes rather encompass all. When we go to clause 33 under Interpretation, we have “athlete means an individual who participates in sports.” So, every sport.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, still on clause 5, with your leave? I have been discussing with the Minister for—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Is the earlier proposed amendment abandoned?

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Yes, it is abandoned. But Mr Speaker, still on clause 5, “application of monies of the fund.” I just want him to include “schools and Colleges sports”. Part of his money must be used for that. This is because I am in discussion with him for us to revive sports in schools and colleges. *[Interruption]* That is fine. I want specific, “schools and colleges sports”. He knows he and I are launching it. I even engage him to look for corporate sponsorship for it, Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** There was a question whether colleges are not schools.

Yes?

**Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth:** Mr Speaker, I just want some clarification. On clause 5(a), it says “promote the development”. Does that mean that the Fund itself cannot also decide to develop infrastructure? I think that promotion should be different and also development of infrastructure should also be added, because we should get to a point that the Fund should be able to raise and develop its own infrastructure for the training. Not just the promotion, but at least development of infrastructure itself. I do not know the take of the Minister on this. Thank you.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Well, it is for the consideration of the House.

Hon Member, is there really a difference?

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Yes, please, there is a difference. Promotion has got to do with advocacy and actual development has got to do with doing it yourself, so there are two twists to it. Unless the understanding is that it is both advocating and also developing.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, my Brother, if you are building an AstroTurf in your Constituency, and it is classified as promotion and development of sports, if they say you are developing sports, you are promoting, is there really a difference?

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Mr Speaker, the key here is development of infrastructure. If they understand that it is not just the advocacy, but it is also the actual development, then I am alright. At least, it goes into the records that it is not just the promotion, but the development of it.

**Mr Mahama Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, maybe we should say “promote or develop infrastructure required for the training of athletes, organisation of tournaments, and participation in sports.” Promotion could just be—As he said, what we did yesterday by passing the Kumasi Expressway Limited, where Ghana Infrastructure Investment Fund (GIIF) sets up a special purpose vehicle. They may not have the money itself, but then can go and look for money, and then develop it, and then recover the investments. That is more like promoting infrastructure development.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Then we should use the conjunctive words rather

than the disjunctive. If the understanding is that the promotion is different from the actual act, then it should be conjunctive but not disjunctive.

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, alternatively we can leave the rendition this way with the understanding that if there is ever a need for interpretation, when they come and consult the *Hansard*, they will be clear that we wanted to also indicate that the Fund could actually directly develop the infrastructure.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, because it should be possible for the Fund to promote and at the same time develop. They can do the two together.

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, we could render it as promote and develop.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. I intend to refer this to the draft person to tidy it up. So, can I put the question on clause 5?

*Question put and amendment agreed to.*

Clause 5 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 6 — Governing body of the fund.

**Mr Jerry Ahmed Shaib:** Mr Speaker, that talks about the governing body of the Fund. The people who are supposed to consist the governing body are listed. In Ghana, apart from the Ministry of Sports and Recreation, the

major institution that deals with sports, which is apolitical, is the Ghana Olympic Committee. They are not represented here. If we are looking at administration of sports funds, they deal with a lot of funding issues. All federations are under the Ghana Olympic Committee.

3:32 p.m.

So, Mr Speaker, I would propose that we should consider, maybe after (h) “Have the President or the Secretary General of the Ghana Olympic Committee as a member of this governing board”.

I so propose, Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** It is for the consideration of the House. Hon Chairperson, what do you say to this?

**Mr Norgbey:** Mr Speaker, yes, we considered this particular proposal at the Committee level, but we were of the view that the composition of the governing board would be too much. So, we decided to limit it to this number. We do not want to make the governing board so large to extend that it may become problematic at decision-making level. That is why we omitted the Ghana Olympic Committee.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Is the Ghana Olympics Committee a juristic person? Is it a registered entity?

**Mr Shaib:** Yes, Mr Speaker. They are a registered entity. It actually comes in as a Non-Governmental Organisation, but they are running all the federations.

They have here “representatives each from the ministries, not below the rank of a director, nominated by their respective ministers, the Minister for Local Government, Chieftaincy and Religious Affairs”, then it comes to the Minister for Finance. Meanwhile, the sole authority that is apolitical, that runs sports, which is an umbrella that all federations are under, is not captured.

Mr Speaker, there are two major positions, either the Chief Executive Officer—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, so you have made your point. What I want to know is whether or not it is a registered entity.

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, sports and athletics have so many associations. Sometimes, there is a battle over recognition of which association is legitimate, which one is not legitimate. Mr Speaker, if we venture into the world of identifying associations and seeking to provide seats for the associations in the governing board, we will not finish today. So, Mr Speaker, it is safer at this stage not to be contentious, to leave the governing board to be state-based.

For instance, as we speak, do you know that Ghana Football Association (GFA) and its monies are not within the purview of the control of the state? Because Fédération Internationale de Football Association (FIFA) does not recognise governments when it comes to football matters. Yesterday, I had a heated debate with somebody. He said that when the money comes from a

World Cup tournament, and I said World Cup tournament money is not the money of the government of Ghana. If GFA gives some of it to government for projects, that is understandable.

So, there is a world of separation that the various athletics and sports associations want to establish between them and government. They do not want the commingling because they do not want governmental control and interference. So, it is safer to keep them out, we raise the money and then we decide how we spend the money. Let us keep it the way that it is structured, otherwise, each and every one of them will now come and start fighting that they must have a seat, and that will create a problem. Let us establish it. As we go on, then we see how it goes.

**Mr Shaib:** Mr Speaker, I normally would agree with the Leader, but I think that we are not getting this clearly. The Ghana Olympic Committee is also known as the National Olympic Committee. In every country, the National Olympic Committee is part of the governing body of any sports fund. Why am I saying so? Because they also receive some funding from other sources, including the Olympic Committee and Commonwealth. This is so that whoever the sports fund administrator is, will not go giving money to a federation or an association *suo motu* without clearance from the Ghana Olympic Committee.

Mr Speaker, the Ghana Olympic Committee is the umbrella under which all other federations are. This is why we

also have to even bring them there. Because if for instance, the argument is that there are federations, and the moment we put the Ghana Olympic Committee on the governing boards, federations will start springing up, that is actually going to stop the federations from springing up. Because we cannot say we have Ghana Weightlifting Federation and Ghana Weightlifting Association. It is the Ghana Olympic Committee that will make that determination and not even Ministry of Sports, because they have the powers to do so.

So, if the president or the secretary-general who is elected by all the federation members, is a representative of the board where monies will be given out, it is actually a better representation to check all the problems that we may face if they are not there. I so submit.

**Mr Adams:** Mr Speaker, ordinarily we would have considered this as just an addition, but it is not just an addition. Like the Chairman of the Committee said, in the initial consideration of the draft, we had them in. But in the course of the process, it became necessary and expedient to take them out.

Mr Speaker, if we look at the Sports Regulation, 2023, the L.I. 2477, it made provision for Ghana Olympics Committee and we also have National Paralympic Committee. Immediately, we begin to travel that journey, like the Leader of the House indicated, we will see the NPC also begin to demand. Then we see other groups start demanding. We wanted to avoid such a situation, so that



they stay out of the Fund and run the federations in an organised manner. They have the Fund that is managed and it goes in there to support them. The National Sports Authority, which superintends over all these groups, is captured in the membership of the governing board. We think that the way it is, it serves us that purpose. I think we should keep it this way. As we move on, we can begin to think about future additions. But for now, I beg my Second Deputy Minority Whip to let us keep it the way it is.

Thank you.

**Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth:** Mine is on some clarification. If we look at the governing body, there is an indication on each of them on where they are coming from or who is appointing them.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, are you talking about inclusion of National Olympic Committee?

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** No, I think my Whip has —

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, I indicated that at Consideration Stage, when an issue is being considered, until we conclude with that, you do not bring another one.

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** He made that indication that he is yielding.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Jerry Ahmed, do you still stick by your amendment.

**Mr Shaib:** Mr Speaker, I do.

*Question put and amendment negatived.*

3:42 p.m.

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Mr Speaker, I want clarification on the governing body, particularly subsections (a) and (b), the Chairperson and the Administrator. If you take a look at the rest, each of them has been indicated who appoints them. But in this case, it is not clear who will be appointing the Chairperson or the Administrator, or whether they will elect them. So, I just wanted the clarification, just like the National Sports Authority (NSA), would be an NSA professional or something. I just want that clarification, because it is not too clear.

Thank you, Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Well, you are right regarding the Chairperson, but regarding the Administrator, it is an institutional representation, so whoever is the Administrator is automatically a member here. We can tidy it up when we come to clause 6(2), by saying that the Chairperson and other members shall be appointed by the President in accordance with Article —

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Thank you, Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, let us look at subsection (g), a representative of retired professional athletes nominated by the Minister. Do we have the Retired Athletes

Association? If so, why is the Minister going to do the nomination for them? Or the Minister is just going to nominate a retired professional athlete?

Yes, Minister?

**Mr K. I. Adams:** Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to clarify this point. We do have retired athletes for various sports. The footballers have theirs, some boxers who have put themselves together and we have for the various sports. Because we may not want to just limit it to one, we need to weigh so the Minister will have the opportunity of balancing and seeing what exactly to go for at what time to satisfy that provision.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, the rendition should be a retired professional athlete nominated by the Minister?

**Mr K. I. Adams:** I think we will adopt that, Mr Speaker.

*Question put and amendment agreed to.*

Now, clause 6(2) states:

“The President shall, in accordance with article 70 of the Constitution, appoint the members of the Board.”

So, how is the Chairman of the Board going to be appointed?

**Mr Norgbey:** Mr Speaker, I think you proposed something earlier.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The President shall, in accordance with Article 70 of the Constitution appoint the Chairperson and other members of the Board. Does that capture —

**Mr Norgbey:** Very well, Mr Speaker.

*Question put and amendment agreed to.*

Clause 6 as amended ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clauses 7 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** It appears Members are not paying attention to the exercise that we are doing. Most of the Members are talking in the background rather than concentrating on what we are doing. Hon Members, it is not the best. Our core function is to make law. Therefore, in the lawmaking process, we should be seen to be participating but not having side conversations.

Clause 8 to 16 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

3:52 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, you cannot turn your back to the mace.

Clause 17 to 26 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 27 — Beneficiaries of the Fund.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Minority Leader?

**Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin):** Mr Speaker, please indulge me to take us back to Clause 3, sub-clause (e) (i) and (ii). Mr Speaker, Clause 3 deals with the sources of moneys for the Fund. The sub-clause (e) talks about:

“three per cent of proceeds derived from the transfer of:

- (i) athletes within the country to sporting clubs in or outside the country;
- (ii) Ghanaian athletes outside the country.”

The question is, the use of the word “proceeds”, what exactly do we mean by saying 3 per cent of proceeds?

Mr Speaker, by law, any Ghanaian who earns an income is required to pay tax. When we say proceeds, are we referring to that income that that athlete has earned as a result of that contract that has been executed for him to be engaged in a sporting activity for a particular club, be it in Ghana or outside Ghana? Or, we are saying that being a Ghanaian, there is a certain mandatory fee that would have to accrue to a State Agency, of which 3 per cent will be deducted?

Mr Speaker, I say so because reading the explanatory memorandum accompanying the Bill, there seems to be no mention of the source of this 3(e) (i) and (ii). And as much as possible, I do

not think that we have to pass a law that we ourselves may not have clarity to. When we do that, we create problems for our courts, because the source document to guide them in interpretation becomes a problem. I say so because I have done a case at the Supreme Court, where when it got to a critical point, the court had to order for *Hansard* and that was what guided them. In fact, they now had to go through the debates on the Floor, and reading the *Official Reports*, let me use proper parliamentary language. By going through the *Official Reports* and the various contributions, they were able to get a sense of the House, and that was a key guide in interpreting the very matter that I had gone to court with. I have seen a facilitator entering the Chamber.

Mr Speaker, at least for the record, Rev Djietror, as Deputy Clerk then, played a key role because they needed the *Hansard* of Parliament within an hour, and I remember chasing him to get those notes.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, Mr Djietror is the Clerk to Parliament.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** No, as he then was, Deputy Clerk.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** As he then was, he was a Deputy Clerk.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** That is so.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** He has never been referred to as a facilitator.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, get the context.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, for the record—

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** No, Mr Speaker, I am saying that as counsel, when the order came, he facilitated the procurement of the *Hansard*.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Well, I did not understand it that way. You just said a facilitator.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** No, I am saying he facilitated because we had only one hour.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well.

So, you want to understand whether the proceeds are the income transfer?

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** That is so. Then, based on that, I can come back—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Minister?

4:02 p.m.

**Mr Adams:** Mr Speaker, thank you, and let me also thank the Minority Leader for bringing this matter up. Transfer proceeds are one-time payments. These are not the weekly or monthly earnings of an athlete. The laws are very clear, and the records are available and verifiable. There is already a system in place where the mother club benefits from the transfer proceeds. Even

the Football Association (FA) benefits from a certain percentage.

Indeed, by FIFA's indication, future transfers would also bring about some benefits to even the mother club. They want to even develop a system that can trace back to the amateur club where the person began. So, when we talk about transfer proceeds, we are referring to the one-time payment, which is properly arranged, and there are beneficiary agencies or angles. It is not every week or month earnings of an athlete.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, with the explanation, let us take the proposed amendment.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, bear with me. They came under a certificate of urgency. We should understand that we are all being rushed; we need to patiently interrogate the issues.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** I have the patience for you, and I thank God for that. But you placed on record that with an explanation, you will come out with an amendment. I am only reminding you of the explanation. So, what is the amendment?

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, with respect, the Minister, in responding to my issue, raised two very important matters. One, the loose agreement that exists where certain deductions are made. Those agreements do not have legislative backing. It could be a contractual agreement, to the extent

that the person has appended their signature.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, what you are doing is never done at the Consideration Stage.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, can I proceed? What we are doing now, what the Minister is proposing, is to legislate. Even if it is a one-time earning, we cannot use legislation to make a deduction; the person is obliged under law to pay a tax on it. It is an earning. Even if it is one-time, income tax is chargeable on same. We cannot say that because of some other arrangement at the FA level or the club level, we want to take advantage now to legislate that a person's earnings must also be charged. Therefore, there must be a percentage that must be deducted at source for same to become part of the sources of money for the fund. I think that it is an overreach.

Since there is already a statutory obligation, this House has enacted a law that requires a person to pay. And it is even constitutional, not only statutory, it is the constitutional provision that gives Parliament the only body with a mandate to enact laws for taxation. But what they are doing is not using this law to tax, and they are not talking about taxation; they are talking about proceeds.

Mr Speaker, having laid the foundation sufficiently on this, I beg to move therefore—To the best of my knowledge, I have not said they agreed with me. I believe that I have made my case sufficiently on this matter and I have

raised the constitutional issue to say that, by law governing this country, one can only tax a person once. One cannot tax and use another legislation to say that—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So, Minority Leader, what is the proposed amendment? That is why I am telling you that what you are doing is not done at the Consideration Stage.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, I have laid the foundation and the explanation for what I want to do. Therefore, I move that clause 3, sub-clause (e), be deleted in its entirety.

*Question put and amendment negatived.*

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, I know you are a football enthusiast, and I know you have a local team back in your Constituency. It is not everything that the Minority Leader has said in respect of (e) which is out of place. Mr Speaker, maybe we should say “3 per cent of net proceeds”. Let us qualify it because from the gross, when there is a transfer, one has to make a deduction to the Ghana Football Association.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Do you have a counter amendment?

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, I need to add my voice. This posture, I beg you, if you do not want us to contribute—[Inaudible]—If they want to rush and pass the Bill, then let it be so.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, he used the word “attitude”.

But I believe the whole world is watching my attitude, as well as the attitude of the Minority Leader. So, do not be worried if the Minority Leader uses the word “attitude”. The judges are out there.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** No problem. I think so. Mr Speaker, I agree; they are judging all of us. Hon Haruna Iddrisu, the Minister for Education, made a proposal for consideration. It is my view that to the extent that the earnings are taxable, this House cannot legislate.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, the rules are clear. You do not raise an issue that has been determined by the House. That forms the basis of your argument and the House has taken a decision on it. So, with all due respect, kindly resume your seat. Let me put the question.

*Question put and amendment agreed to.*

Clause 27 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Clause 28—Application to the Fund.

4:12 p.m.

**Mr Mohammed Adamu Ramadan:** Mr Speaker, I beg to move that the rendition for 28(3); “the administrator shall within 10 days”. The 10 days will then now include even weekends and holidays. So, if we can qualify it and say 10 working days, so that we can put —

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members the Interpretation Act is clear. If it is 10 days and it is 10 working days, we know what it means.

*Question put and amendment agreed to.*

Clause 28 to 30 ordered to stand part of the Bill.

Yes, Minority Leader?

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker I have been on my feet for more than seven minutes. We come into this Chamber to respect the Chair and not to disrespect the Chair.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, you do not insult the Chair and create the impression that you are respecting the Chair.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Nobody has insulted you. In all humility, nobody has insulted you and if I have done so, I would readily apologise to you. I will not insult you. You are my senior Brother. I would not do that. There is there is a growing trend in this Chamber and it is us in the Minority who will speak about it. Bills are brought; we are hurried and rushed. We are told that this thing is being done under certificate of urgency. Yesterday, when it was introduced, we raised a concern. The Committee has put together a Report. I am the Leader of my Side and this is the first time I am seeing this. When I was Majority Leader, at least the practise then was that our Ministers would give the Bills to Leaders to peruse even before they are tabled.

Ask Hon Kofi Adams. We have a very good working relationship. Ask him whether he has ferried this Bill at least to me.

I am seeing it for the first time. I have issues. When we are making a point that we are being rushed. Hon Haruna Iddrisu has been a Leader before. We work together. He knows.

Let us be fair sometimes. Hon Kofi Adams, he knows me. He has an important Bill and he would not engage but rather comes in to say it should be taken under certificate of urgency. When we want to interrogate issues, it is as if we want to obstruct government business or frustrate it.

Mr Speaker, it does not work and I will say it. I will never disrespect you. But what we are doing in this Chamber does not help the cause of democracy. What is the rush? Where are we rushing to? What is the urgency? If the Minister for Sports and Recreation knew that this was urgent, why did he come within 24 hours to say because a lot of changes were done at winnowing, it is presumed that nothing can be raised.

Mr Speaker, with respect, if you want to stop me, I would put my microphone off and sit down. I would not challenge you. Do you want to stop me?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes. Hon Members we are all human beings. We have done up to clause 30. You know the Rules. If a Question is put on a clause though at Consideration Stage the rules are relaxed. You came and you took me

back from clause 21 to clause 3 and when you took me to clause 3 magnanimously, I allowed you bending all the rules in your favour. Now what we do at Consideration Stage, is you look at the provision and if you disagree, you propose an amendment. But you came saying you are seeking clarity. The Minister should clarify for you and he did. You have rightly indicated that based on the clarification you want to propose an amendment. Instead of proposing an amendment you engage in an argument. Then you say I am putting up an attitude. I took offence from the use of the word attitude and I think I have not done anything negative towards you.

Indulging you to take me from clause 21 to clause 3, is that the attitude that I have shown to you? And you claim to be showing me respect? I do not consider that to be respect. I do not consider that to be respect to the Chair. You cannot be insulting me in disguise and claim you are respecting me. It is not done anywhere. That is why I place on record that Ghanaians should look at my attitude as well as your attitude in this Chamber and they can come to a conclusion.

Yes, let me hear you.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, from what you have just said, the impression I gather is that the use of the word “attitude” referring to the general trend in how things are arranged in this Chamber was as though it was directed at you personally. That was not the intent. If in the construction, it came across as such, then I withdraw same.

Because you are the Presiding Officer, my duty is to protect you by showing you respect.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Add an apology to it.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Very well. That would help.

Mr Speaker, if that impression was created, then please find a place in your heart to let it go.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Thank you very much.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, however, I believe that you got the crux of my submission to the effect that as Parliamentarians, we need sufficient time to peruse matters.

Mr Speaker, as recent as last two weeks, my eyes were opened to this Artificial Intelligence (AI) technology that is taking over matters. Whereas in other parliaments, they have access to this technology to aid them, we do not have it.

So, I would want to also appeal through the Chair to my Colleagues opposite me that the approach in handling Government Business should be such that it should offer all of us the opportunity to peruse matters properly. So that we do not get a backlash or so that when we pass laws, it gets out there to stand the test of time.

This particular situation where the Bill was referred yesterday under a

certificate of urgency, and then we are rushing it through is quite problematic. I just want to register that concern.

I rest my case.

4:22 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, this whole thing started yesterday, when the Hon Minister indicated that he wants the Bill to be considered under a certificate of urgency. Then, the indication was that the Hon Minister did not have the right to say so, and I had to refer the House to the Standing Order 160, as well as Article 106, that it is pursuant to that indication that I can refer the Bill to the Committee to consider the urgency or otherwise of the Bill.

The Committee is made up of Hon Members from both Sides. The Committee brought a unanimous Report, and everybody who spoke to the determination of the urgency or otherwise were all in favour of the Bill being taken under a certificate of urgency. I put the Question on the Motion numbered 25, and the Motion was carried by the House. It was after that that I moved the Bill to the Consideration Stage. When the Bill was being withdrawn yesterday, the explanation was that the Committee met, considered the Bill and proffered amendments; the amendments were a lot, and therefore, they referred the matter back to the Attorney-General's Department to integrate the amendments of the Committee into the Bill. So, they were withdrawing and relaying the Bill.



Hon Members, this Bill has been with us for some time. So, any Hon Member who studies the Bill may not come arguing. You have formed your opinion, and you want to proffer amendments for a designated clause, and when you come to the Consideration Stage, particularly in a period like this, you go straight and propose your amendment, and then we will put a Question on the amendment, and the House will then take a decision based on the amendment; that is what we do. But if you want to argue instead of proposing amendments for consideration of the House, I would have a problem because I do not know if that is what we are supposed to do at a Consideration Stage.

So, Hon Members, let us make progress.

Clause 31 — Collaboration with National Lottery Authority.

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Mr Speaker. I was hoping to catch your eye, to indulge you, to bring us to clause 27.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, I would not put up that reverse gear. I have seen some attempts here. I was on clause 27, and I moved to clause 28, 29, 30 and I am now on clause 31. You can do a Second Consideration.

Any proposed amendment to clause 31?

Yes, Minister for Education?

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, clause 31, "...special sports lotteries for sports development".

Mr Speaker, they do not need to qualify it with the purposes of "sports development". It is just a question to the Chairperson.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The proposed amendment is for the consideration of the House. So, your rendition will be to *delete* "for the purpose". So, give us the new rendition.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, after "for" *insert* "for purposes of sports development", but it does no harm, though.

Clause 31 as amended is ordered to stand part of the Bill,

Clause 32 — Regulations.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Chairperson of the Committee?

**Mr Norgbey:** Mr Speaker, no advertised amendments.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** It is for the consideration of the House.

Yes, Hon Minister for Education, let me hear you.

**Mr Haruna Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, clause 32, line 1, "The Minister shall, in consultation with the Board," do we need to *insert* "and by Legislative Instrument".

Mr Speaker, I withdraw my amendment.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. Because this appears to be the standard agreed rendition.

Clause 32 is ordered to stand part of the bill.

Clause 33 — Interpretation.

Hon Members, I will then consider it page by page.

Page 21...page 23 —

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Mr Speaker, the definition for “sports” appears twice. All right, one is spelt with an “s”, and the other is spelt without an “s”.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Which page?

**Mr Addo-Kenneth:** Page 22 has ““Sport” means an organised physical activity or competitive event involving professionals or amateurs...” and then “Sports” means organised competitive activity involving the elite professional athletes.”

Mr Speaker, because the “Sport” is one activity and “Sports” is a general activity; and they are almost the same, but maybe the Hon Minister may clarify.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minister, why are you defining “sport” differently from “sports”?

**Mr Adams:** Mr Speaker, the two words have been used in the course of the Bill to give different meanings, and it is

that meaning that has been captured in the interpretation column. So, we would not have any issue.

Clause 33 and 34 ordered to stand part of the Bill

The Schedule is ordered to stand part of the Bill

The Long title is ordered to stand part of the Bill

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, this brings us to the end of the Consideration Stage of the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025. Hon Members, the Motion numbered 31 on page 16 of the main Order Paper, by the Hon Minister for Sports and Recreation.

4:32 p.m.

## **BILL — THIRD READING**

### **Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025**

**Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams) (MP):** Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 be now read the Third time.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Minority Chief Whip?

**Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompheh):** Mr Speak, maybe I am late. We have spoken to the Bill that we will do the Consideration Stage. I thought that we could rather take the item on GNPC Work Programme and Budget,

because we were waiting on clearance. I got communication from — Mr Speaker, we can allow some time to elapse. We will take the GNPC Work Programme and Budget, and if he so please, we can go ahead and take it. Ideally, we should have just allowed a day to pass. *[Interruption]* That has been the practice. It is captured in our Standing Orders.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Let us get it clear, after the House has adopted the Motion to take the Bill under certificate of urgency, based on Article 106(13) of the 1992 Constitution?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, I am only suggesting to the Majority Frontbench—that was the agreement.

**Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong):** Mr Speaker, in the early hours of today, you did refer the Ghana Investment Promotion Authority Bill to the Budget Committee. Mr Speaker, if we check Standing Order 260(2), it says:

“The Committee shall have referred to it, matters that relate to State interest and public administration and has jurisdiction to investigate and enquire into the activities and administration of

(g) any other agency under the supervision of the Office of Government Machinery.”

Mr Speaker, if you check the Medium-Term Expenditure Framework (MTEF) of 2026, in the Office of

Government Machinery, we will find the GIPC there. It is well placed under the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests, not the Budget Committee. We can add the Leadership of either the Finance Committee or Budget Committee, but the referral should go to the Committee on Public Administration and State interests.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, I would then withdraw the referral and rather refer it to the Committee on Public Administration and State Interests, and ask that the Leadership of the Budget Committee and the Committee on Trade, Industry and Tourism should join them, consider it and report to the House.

**Mr Acheampong:** Very well, I am most grateful Mr Speaker.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Chief Whip, until the Report is ready, we cannot proceed with that one.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** I got an indication that the GNPC Report is ready. So, we can proceed and take the item numbered 23.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Majority Leader, is the Report ready?

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, that is so, it has been ready for some time. It has been loaded onto the console, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, in respect of the Motion numbered 23, the Chairperson is not available, so I pray that the Vice

Chairperson of the Committee takes the Report.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Minority Bench, the indication is that the Vice Chairperson —

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, I am not opposing. The Chairperson has not been seen the whole week. I have not seen him. I have not mentioned anybody's name. I am referring to the Chairperson of the Committee. He has not been seen. Has he travelled? Hon Majority Chief Whip, tell the House the whereabouts of the Chair.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, my Brother knows where the Chairperson is. I know that he went on ECOWAS duties, so he is not back. It is the Vice Chairperson who is in charge of these matters for a couple of days now. Mr Speaker, he is competent and well-appointed to do this on his behalf.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The indication is that they are not opposed, but they need to know where the Chairperson is. I will give the opportunity to the Vice Chairperson of the Committee—

Yes?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, we will allow that, but I want to remind my respected Majority Chief Whip that we are rising tomorrow. There are matters of importance. I do not need to elucidate. I am told that the Minister was here a while ago. He has attempted to resolve the issue, but there are still

outstanding matters. Look at the mood of the House. Carry Members along. We are rising tomorrow. Majority Chief Whip, I am just nudging you. Do not let me surprise you. Please, do the needful.

Mr Speaker, we are not opposed, but they should do the needful.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. Hon Vice Chairperson of the Committee, you may now move the Motion numbered 23 on the *Order Paper*.

## MOTION

### Work Programme and Budget of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation

**Vice Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Naser Toure Mahama) on behalf of the Chairperson of the Committee:** Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That this honourable House adopts the Report of the Committee on Energy on the Work Programme and Budget of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC) for the year 2026.

In so doing, I present the Report of the Committee, and urge *Hansard* to capture the Report as having been read in its entirety.

## Introduction

The 2026 Work Programme of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation

(GNPC) was laid in Parliament on Wednesday, 10<sup>th</sup> December 2025 by the Deputy Minister for Lands and Natural Resources, Alhaji Yusif Sulemana, on behalf of the Hon Minister for Energy and Green Transition, in accordance with Section 7(3)(b) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815) as amended.

The Rt Hon Speaker subsequently referred the Work Programme to the Committee on Energy for consideration and report pursuant to Orders 97(5) and 252 of the Standing Orders of the House.

### **Deliberations**

The Committee met with the Hon Deputy Minister for Energy and Green Transition, Alhaji Yusif Sulemana and considered the Work Programme. A technical team from GNPC led by the Chief Executive Officer, Mr Kwame Ntow Amoah also attended the meeting.

The Committee expresses its profound appreciation to the Deputy Minister and his team from the Ministry as well as Officials from GNPC for attending upon the Committee and assisting in the deliberations.

### **Reference Documents**

The Committee referred to the following documents during its deliberations:

- i. The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana;
- ii. The Standing Orders of Parliament;

- iii. The Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815);
- iv. The Petroleum Revenue Management (Amendment) Act, 2015 (Act 893);
- v. The Petroleum (Exploration and Production) Act, 2016 (Act 919);
- vi. The Ghana National Petroleum Corporation Act, 1983 (PNDCL 64);
- vii. The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government for the 2026 Financial Year;
- viii. The Petroleum Hub Development Corporation Act, 2020 (Act 1053);
- ix. The 2024 Work Programme of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation; and
- x. The 2025 Work Programme of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation.

### **Background Information**

GNPC was established in 1983 pursuant to the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation Act, 1983 (PNDC Law 64). GNPC is mandated by its enabling enactment to undertake the exploration, development, production and disposal of petroleum in the country (Section 2(1) of PNDCL 64).

By the provisions of Section 10 of the Petroleum (Exploration and Production) Act, 2016 (Act 919), GNPC is a necessary party to all petroleum agreements entered into with international oil companies and holds the interests of the State in all petroleum blocks.

GNPC is mandated to ensure that the country derives optimal benefits from the exploitation of petroleum resources managed by it, the development of national capabilities along the entire petroleum value chain, and the conduct of petroleum activities in such a manner that minimises adverse impact on the environment and the people of Ghana.

A portion of petroleum revenue is to be ceded to fund the activities of GNPC pursuant to the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815).

Section 7(3)(b) of Act 815 requires Parliament to approve the activities of GNPC for each year. In accordance with the regulatory requirement, the Hon Minister laid the 2026 Work Programme of GNPC in the House for approval.

### **Vision, Mission and Strategic Objectives of GNPC**

The vision of GNPC is to become a global Oil and Gas Exploration and Production Company whose operations will have a profound impact on the quality of life of the people of Ghana.

The mission of GNPC is to lead the sustainable exploration, development, production and disposal of the petroleum

resources of Ghana, by leveraging the right mix of domestic and foreign investments in partnership with the people of Ghana.

The strategic objective of GNPC is to become a strong and efficient oil and gas exploration and production operator with significant financial independence by 2030.

### **Medium-Term Priority Areas (2021-2026)**

GNPC has undertaken to pursue the following prioritised targets:

- i. Work towards increasing reserves and optimising production;
- ii. Building capacity and raising standards;
- iii. Securing Financial Sustainability;
- iv. Integrating Environmental, Social, and Governance Standards and Reporting and Green Energy;
- v. Establishing Compliance and Operational Standards;
- vi. Attracting international major players such as Shell, BP, CNOOC, and Exxon Mobil;
- vii. Fostering a strong organisational culture; and

- viii. Building strong stakeholder relationships.

### **Performance of GNPC in 2025**

The operational performance of GNPC and its Partners in 2025 is summarised as follows:

#### **Petroleum Business**

Together with its Partners, GNPC achieved the following under its Petroleum business operations in 2025:

- i. Drilled and completed 2 development wells (J72-P and SNKE 1XST2);
- ii. Acquired additional 3 per cent interest in the DWT/CTP block

#### **Greater Jubilee Field:**

- i. Successfully drilled and completed one development well (J72-P);
- ii. Achieved average daily oil production of 61,437 barrels (bbls); and
- iii. Achieved average gas export of 81.89 million standard cubic feet per day (MMscf/d).

#### **Tweneboa-Enyenra-Ntomme (TEN) Field:**

- i. Achieved average daily oil production of 16,288 bbls; and

- ii. Undertook fabric maintenance, asset integrity improvement campaign and engineering projects to further improve facility uptime.

#### **Sankofa-Gye Nyame (SGN) Field:**

- i. Produced 6.71 MMbbls of oil, averaging 24,594 bopd;
- ii. Exported 63.92 Bcf of gas, averaging 234.13 MMScf/d;
- iii. Lifted 2 (CAPI) parcels of crude oil; and
- iv. Performed fabric maintenance, asset integrity improvement campaign and subsea network inspection to improve the efficiency and uptime of the facility

#### **Deepwater Tano Cape Three Points Block (DWT-CTP):**

- i. Completed tender evaluations for key packages, including FPSO EPC, Subsea Umbilical Riser Flowlines (SURF), and Subsea Production System (SPS), with non-binding Letters of Intent (LOIs) issued to contractors;
- ii. Completed seismic reprocessing activities; and

- iii. GNPC has exercised its rights to acquire the additional 3 per cent participating interest, as per the terms of the DWT/CTP Petroleum Agreement.

### **Exploration and Appraisal Projects**

#### **Voltaian Basin Project (VBP):**

- i. Produced a report confirming well location for drilling of one (1) exploration well;
- ii. Conducted geological analysis of datasets to enhance the understanding of the basin's prospectivity; and
- iii. Executed eleven (11) Master Service Level Agreement (MSLA) job packages on behalf of GNPC Explorco

#### **GH-CB-01 Block:**

- i. GNPC acquired the license to operate the block in 2025
- ii. Conducted preliminary technical studies over the Central Basin
- iii. Applied to the Minister for Energy and Green Transition for an exclusive reconnaissance license to advance exploration efforts

### **Capital Projects**

The Corporation achieved the following milestones under its capital projects in 2025:

- i. Accra Head Office Project
  - Completed 86.97 per cent of structural frame of the 18-storey office structure
  - Achieved a cumulative 61.36 per cent of physical level of completion
- ii. Research and Technology Centre (RAT)
  - Achieved 94.73 per cent cumulative completion level for Phase 1, for civil and building works.

### **Outlook for 2026**

GNPC plans to undertake the following programmes in 2026:

#### **Development and Production Projects**

GNPC plans to undertake a number of projects under its development and production projects in 2026 some which include the following:

#### **Greater Jubilee Field**

The Greater Jubilee Field, GNPC, and its Partners plan to undertake the following production activities:



- i. Achieve crude oil production of 64,300 barrels per day (bopd);
- ii. Achieve gas export of 100 MMscf/d;
- iii. Lift four (4) parcels of crude oil;
- iv. Drill four development (4) wells and complete five (5) development wells;
- v. Workover one (1) development well; and
- vi. Continue Reservoir engineering studies, well maturation exercises and Production Surveillance for the efficient Jubilee Field subsurface management to achieve facility uptime of 95 per cent.

The Greater Jubilee Partners' estimated total project cost for 2026 is US\$677.80 million. In accordance with GNPC's interest, a total of US\$55.67 million has been budgeted.

### **Tweneboa-Enyenra-Ntomme (TEN) Field**

GNPC and its Partners plan to undertake the following activities at the Tweneboa-Enyenra-Ntomme Field:

- i. Achieve crude oil production of 14,299 bopd;

- ii. Achieve gas export of 2.79 MMScf/d;
- iii. Lift one (1) parcel of crude oil;
- iv. Continue Fabric Maintenance, Asset Integrity Improvement Campaign & Engineering projects to further improve facility performance uptime of 95 per cent; and
- v. Conduct the processing and interpretation of 580sq.km of Ocean Bottom Node (OBN) seismic data acquired

The projected total cost for the TEN field is US\$341.60 million. In accordance with GNPC's interest, a total of US\$28.10 million has been budgeted.

### **Sankofa Gye-Nyame (SGN) Field**

With regards to the Sankofa Gye-Nyame (SGN) Field, GNPC and its Partners have committed to execute the following activities:

- i. Achieve 25,363 bopd of crude oil production;
- ii. Achieve 249 MMScf/d of gas export;
- iii. Lift two (2) parcels of crude oil;
- iv. Bring one oil producing well (OP-3ST) online producer; and

- v. Conduct maintenance, assets integrity improvement campaigns, and subsea network inspections to enhance facility efficiency and attain a facility uptime of 95 per cent.

The SGN field estimated total cost for 2026 is US\$610.42 million. In accordance with GNPC's interest, a total of US\$73.84 million has been budgeted.

### **Decommissioning of Saltpond Field**

The major activity earmarked for 2026 is to procure the services of Third-Party Verification Company to evaluate Contractor's claim and determine remaining works to be done. A budgetary allocation of US\$2.06 million has been earmarked for this project.

### **Exploration and Appraisal Projects**

On exploration and appraisal projects, GNPC intend to undertake the following activities:

#### **Voltaian Basin Project**

On the Voltaian Basin Project (VBP), GNPC and its Partners plan to undertake the following activities:

- i. Subsurface risk reduction;
- ii. Stakeholder engagements & CSR;
- iii. Technical & environmental studies; and

- iv. Drill one reconnaissance well.  
A budgetary allocation of US\$19.09 million has been earmarked for this project.

### **GH-CB-01 Block**

- i. Conduct Geological and Geophysical studies;
- ii. Promote block to attract a competent partner;
- iii. Acquire 1,200sq.km of 3D seismic data; and
- iv. Apply for Petroleum Agreement with a new partner.

A budgetary allocation of US\$7.54 million has been earmarked for these activities.

### **Gas Business Project**

GNPC intends to undertake the following activities under its Gas Business Project. The total budgetary allocation for Tema Gas City Gate and the Gas Distribution Pipeline Project is US\$5.00 million.

Tema Gas City Gate and Distribution Pipeline:

- i. Select a potential partner;
- ii. Reassess the FEED for the project; and
- iii. Procure an Engineering Construction Installation

and Commissioning (EPCIC) contractor reassessment/completion, and EPCIC procurement.

iv. Put together an operational readiness team in anticipation of project commencement.

### Distribution Pipeline Project

- i. Complete ongoing FEED;
- ii. Select Potential partner; and
- iii. Procure Engineering Procurement Construction Installation and Commission (EPCIC) contractor.

### LNG Terminal Acquisition

- i. Conduct third-party verification audit of current project status and asset valuation;
- ii. Select potential investor to partner GNPC to acquire this strategic asset;
- iii. Select new contractors or renew existing contracts to complete scope of works; and

### Financial Requirement for 2026

Ghana National Petroleum Corporation's (GNPC) activities in 2026 are projected to generate a total budgeted revenue of US\$1,433.57 million against a total budgeted expenditure of US\$1,635.79 million, resulting in a funding deficit of US\$202.22 million. This gap is expected to be financed by:

- Estimated cash balance brought forward;
- Term loan;
- External support – GNPC Foundation; and
- Collection of GoG and other receivables as per Table A below:

*Table A: GoG & Other Receivables*

| GoG & Other Receivables                                       | 2026 Allocation    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
|                                                               | US\$               |
| Genser (Gas Delivered)                                        | 39,662,349         |
| Prestea Sankofa Gold Ltd.                                     | 20,485,000         |
| Liquified Natural Gas Stand-by Letters Credit Fees – Tema LNG | 9,600,000          |
| Tema Oil Refinery                                             | 33,800,000         |
| Enclave Roads – Legacy Roads                                  | 33,825,000         |
| GNGC Offshore Pipeline                                        | 22,040,756         |
| <b>TOTAL</b>                                                  | <b>159,413,104</b> |

GNPC's key priorities for 2026 include arresting the oil production decline, driving oil and gas exploration and production growth, exploration drilling in the Voltain Basin, securing gas investment, strengthening organisational

capacity, and proactively engaging with stakeholders. The Corporation's 2026 work programme, together with the associated revenue and expenditure is outlined in Table 2 below:

*Table 2: 2026 Funds Requirement*

|                                                               | Budget    | Budget    |
|---------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|-----------|
|                                                               | 2026      | 2025      |
| Crude Oil price per barrel                                    | US\$76.22 | US\$74.70 |
| Expected Number of Cargoes                                    | 7         | 8         |
| <u>REVENUE</u>                                                | US\$m     | US\$m     |
| <u>Equity Financing</u>                                       | 157.61    | 155.69    |
| Jubilee Field                                                 | 55.67     | 60.75     |
| TEN Field                                                     | 28.10     | 24.02     |
| SGN Field                                                     | 73.84     | 70.92     |
|                                                               |           |           |
| <u>Net Share of Carried and Participating Interest (CAPI)</u> | 37.47     | 44.23     |
| Jubilee Field                                                 | 23.00     | 29.30     |
| TEN Field                                                     | 3.82      | 4.28      |
| SGN Field                                                     | 10.65     | 10.65     |
|                                                               |           |           |
| TOTAL OIL REVENUE                                             | 195.08    | 199.92 -  |
|                                                               |           |           |
| TRAINING GRANT                                                | 3.85      | 3.85      |
| Training Grant                                                | 3.85      | 3.85      |
|                                                               |           |           |
| MISCELLANEOUS INCOME                                          | 24.14     | 19.82     |
| Services to Subsidiary - Explorco                             | 13.70     | 12.00     |
| Data License - Voltaian Basin                                 | 10.00     | 7.00      |
| Sundries                                                      | 0.44      | 0.82      |
| TOTAL REVENUE                                                 | 223.07    | 223.59    |

|                               | Budget | Budget |
|-------------------------------|--------|--------|
|                               | 2026   | 2025   |
| <u>EXPENDITURE</u>            | US\$m  | US\$m  |
| DEVELOPMENT & PRODUCTION COST | 210.89 | 200.38 |

|                                                      |          |          |
|------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|
| Jubilee                                              | 75.12    | 69.95    |
| Tweneboa Enyenra & Ntomme - DWT                      | 41.89    | 39.11    |
| OCTP (ENI) Sankofa- Gye Nyame Complex                | 91.82    | 81.27    |
| Saltpond Field Decommissioning                       | 2.06     | 10.06    |
|                                                      |          |          |
| EXPLORATION & APPRAISAL PROJECTS                     | 26.64    | 1.13     |
| Voltaian Basin Project                               | 19.09    | 1.13     |
| GH-CB-01 Block                                       | 7.54     | --       |
| GAS BUSINESS PROJECT                                 | 5.00     | -        |
| Tema (Gas) City Gate & Distribution Pipeline Project | 5.00     | --       |
| MIDSTREAM & OTHER PROJECTS                           | 30.75    | 5.00     |
| LNG Terminal Acquisition                             | 28.75    | -        |
| Gas Evacuation Enclave Roads                         | 2.00     | 5.00     |
|                                                      |          |          |
|                                                      | Budget   | Budget   |
|                                                      | 2026     | 2025     |
|                                                      | US\$m    | US\$m    |
| CAPITAL PROJECTS                                     | 65.51    | 70.27    |
| Corporate Office                                     | 41.12    | 41.78    |
| Research and Technology Centre                       | 17.14    | 16.89    |
| Works on Landed Properties                           | 1.20     | 3.04     |
| Digital Transformation                               | 6.05     | 8.57     |
| NON OPERATING EXPENDITURE                            | 14.23    | 9.17     |
| GNPC Foundation                                      | 11.23    | 8.64     |
| Boundary Projects                                    | 3.00     | 0.53     |
| OPERATING EXPENDITURE                                | 84.46    | 62.42    |
| Personnel Emoluments                                 | 42.93    | 33.93    |
| Admin Capital                                        | 8.08     | 5.46     |
| General Expenses                                     | 33.44    | 23.02    |
| TOTAL EXPENDITURE                                    | 437.48   | 348.37   |
|                                                      |          | -        |
| NET POSITION BEFORE FINANCING                        | (214.41) | (124.78) |

|                           |          |          |
|---------------------------|----------|----------|
|                           | Budget   | Budget   |
|                           | 2026     | 2025     |
| GAS BUSINESS              | US\$m    | US\$m    |
| REVENUE FROM GAS BUSINESS | 1,210.51 | 1,060.09 |
| Jubilee/Sankofa Gye Nyame | 1,210.51 | 264.29   |
|                           |          |          |

|                                                                  |          |          |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|----------|
| GAS BUSINESS COST                                                | 1,198.31 | 1,055.52 |
| Gas Processing Fee - Jubilee                                     | 138.07   | 137.42   |
| Sankofa Gye Nyame - Commodity                                    | 789.06   | 718.76   |
| Transportation Cost GNGC                                         | 73.98    | 101.83   |
| WAGP Reverse Flow                                                | 84.09    | 85.86    |
| Genser Reservation Pipeline Cost                                 | 96.93    | 9.78     |
| Gas Nomination Services                                          | 11.72    | -        |
| Gas Financing Costs                                              | 1.67     | -        |
| Other Gas Business Cost                                          | 2.80     | 1.87 -   |
| Gas Business Net Margin                                          | 12.20    | 4.57     |
| Total Net Position - Oil & Gas                                   | (202.22) | (120.20) |
|                                                                  | Budget   | Budget   |
|                                                                  | 2026     | 2025     |
|                                                                  | US\$m    | US\$m    |
| Total Net Position - Oil & Gas                                   | (202.22) | (120.20) |
| Financed By:                                                     |          |          |
|                                                                  | 1.85     | 2.00     |
| Projected Cash Balance C/fwd                                     | 1.85     | 2.00 -   |
| Project Financing                                                | 44.49    | 45.00    |
| Corporate Head Office (CHO) Anchor Tenancy                       | -        | 15.00    |
| Bank Loan Facility                                               | 40.00    | 30.00    |
| External Support - GNPC Foundation                               | 4.49     | --       |
| Receivables:                                                     | 159.41   | 73.40    |
| Genser (Gas Delivered)                                           | 39.66    | 19.78    |
| Prestea Sankofa Gold Ltd                                         | 20.49    | 9.64     |
| Liquified Natural Gas Stand by Letters of Credit Fees - Tema LNG | 9.60     | 9.60     |
| HSBC Continental Europe - Ministry of Finance                    | -        | 2.97     |
| OCTP Escrow - Ministry of Finance                                | -        | 15.43    |
| Tema Oil Refinery                                                | 33.80    | 9.01     |
| Enclave Roads - Legacy Roads                                     | 33.83    | 6.96     |
| GNGC Offshore Pipeline                                           | 22.04    | -        |
|                                                                  |          | -        |

|                              |        |        |
|------------------------------|--------|--------|
| Total                        | 205.76 | 120.40 |
|                              |        |        |
| NET POSITION AFTER FINANCING | 3.54   | 0.20   |

## Observations

The Committee made the following observations during the deliberations:

### Strategic Increase in Exploration Funding

The Committee observed an intensified investment in exploration and appraisal activities, notably, the allocation for exploration projects such as the Voltaian Basin Project (US\$19.09 million) and the GH-CB-01 Block (US\$7.54 million).

The Committee notes that these investments demonstrate the Corporation's renewed commitment to addressing the continued decline in oil production through an aggressive programme of onshore and offshore exploration, including the drilling of reconnaissance wells in the Voltaian Basin, which covers approximately 40 per cent of Ghana's landmass.

### Widening Funding Gap and Emerging Cash Flow Concerns

The Committee further observed that the Corporation's funding deficit has widened significantly from US\$124.78 million in 2025 to US\$214.41 million in 2026 prior to financing. This shortfall necessitates increased reliance on, among others, external borrowing

(US\$40 million), projected cash balances, and the recovery of receivables amounting to US\$159.41million.

The Committee is concerned that this trend exposes the Corporation to heightened cash-flow vulnerabilities, particularly given its dependence on payments from entities such as Genser and the Tema Oil Refinery.

The Committee also notes that, although the gas business segment generates a modest net margin of US\$12.20 million, it records a notable growth in revenue from US\$1,060.09 million in 2025 to US\$1,210.51 million in 2026, largely driven by supplies from the Jubilee and Sankofa Gye Nyame fields, an indication of improving performance in gas monetization

### Prioritisation of Major Capital Investments

The Committee additionally observed that capital projects account for a significant portion of the Corporation's budget, amounting to US\$65.51 million. The largest components of this expenditure relate to the construction of the Accra Head Office (US\$41.12 million) and the establishment of the Research and Technology Centre (RATC) (US\$17.14 million). These initiatives are intended to strengthen operational efficiency, support digital transformation, and enhance

environmental stewardship in alignment with global energy transition priorities. The Committee, however, notes with concern the continued delays in the decommissioning of the Saltpond Field, for which US\$2.06 million has been budgeted. The protracted delay poses ongoing environmental, operational, and financial risks that warrant urgent attention.

### **Allocation to the GNPC Foundation**

The Committee further observed that the allocation of **US\$11.23 million** to the **GNPC Foundation** appears inadequate, particularly in view of the anticipated commencement of activities under the **Voltaian Basin Project**. The Committee noted that the Foundation plays a critical role in delivering the Corporation's corporate social responsibility interventions.

Given these considerations, the Committee is of the view that the current allocation may not be sufficient to enable the Foundation to effectively discharge its mandate and to facilitate the smooth integration of the project within the beneficiary communities, including community development initiatives in project-affected areas.

### **Conclusion and Recommendation**

Together with its Partners, GNPC's 2026 Work Programme and Budget sets out a strategic plan to strengthen the petroleum sector amid global economic and energy transition challenges. GNPC projects revenues of US\$1,433.57 million and expenditures of

US\$1,635.79 million, leaving a US\$202.22 million deficit to be covered through cash balances, loans, external support, and the recovery of Government and third-party receivables.

Key priorities include stabilising production in mature fields such as Jubilee, TEN, and Sankofa-Gye Nyame; accelerating exploration in the Voltaian Basin and GH-CB-01 Block; and expanding gas infrastructure through the Tema Gas City Gate, Distribution Pipeline, and potential LNG Terminal acquisition. GNPC also plans to strengthen institutional capacity through capital investments, digitalisation, and social initiatives under the GNPC Foundation.

The Committee deems the execution of the above projects by GNPC in 2026 as critical to sustaining the country's oil and gas production and exploration.

In that regard, the Committee recommends to the House to adopt this report and approve the 2026 Work Programme of GNPC in accordance with Section 7(3)(b) of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011 (Act 815) as amended.

Respectfully submitted.

4:42 p.m.

Mr Speaker, GNPC projects revenues of US\$1,433.57 million and expenditures of US\$1,635.79 million, leaving US\$202.22 million deficit to be converted through cash balances, loans, external supports and the recovery of



Government and third-party receivables. I so move.

**Ranking Member of the Committee (Mr George Kwame Aboagye):** Thank you, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity. Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion for the report on the Committee on Energy on the Work Programme and Budget of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation for the year 2026.

Mr Speaker, we all know that GNPC's mandate is to develop national capabilities along the entire petroleum value chain and to conduct petroleum activities in such a manner that minimises adverse impact. Also, one of their strategic objectives is to become a strong and efficient oil and gas exploration production operator with significant financial independence by 2030.

Mr Speaker, GNPC has enumerated a lot of activities for 2026 and some of their activities are to complete their head office project, which is about 87 per cent complete, and then their research and technology centre, which is about 95 per cent complete. The research centre happens to be the fourth of its kind in Africa and when it is completed, GNPC will not take their subsea data analysis outside the country again. Normally, they take it to Europe and other places, but this is going to be a centre of best practise that other African countries also can access.

In 2026, GNPC will try and complete the decommissioning of Saltpond Oil

field, which has been a contentious issue for quite some time now. This is because the operator at the Saltpond Oil field has bolted, which has become a burden on GNPC.

The much-awaited Volta Basin is also in line for 2026. The Volta Basin is about 40 per cent landmass of Ghana. In this case, there are a lot of inhabitants by the Volta Basin, which is an onshore project. So, Mr Speaker, when it comes to corporate social responsibilities, GNPC will need much money for these activities because there are a lot of inhabitants along all these routes. Their environmental impact assessment also needs to be carried very well.

In this case, Mr Speaker, the amount that GNPC has earmarked for 2026 is US\$1,433,057 million; that is what is available, but the real amount is US\$1,635,079,000, which means there is going to be a deficit of US\$202,022,000.

Mr Speaker, GNPC participating and carried interest, which has to be given by the Government, has been reduced drastically. When we look at 2024 Budget, what was given to GNPC was US\$142 million. This year, as of September, only US\$35 million has been given to GNPC as they are participating and carried interest. In this 2026 Budget, only \$40 million has been earmarked for GNPC.

GNPC has a lot of work to do in 2026, especially with the Voltaian Basin, which is a new area with all the necessary activities that are going to happen there. So, I urge the Minister for Finance to try as much as possible to top

up GNPC's allocations so that they can carry on their activities that have been earmarked for 2026. Mr Speaker, I urge this House to adopt this report and approve the work plan and budget for GNPC in 2026.

*Question proposed.*

**Dr Albert Tetteh Nyakotey (NDC — Yilo Krobo):** Mr Speaker, I rise to contribute in support of the Motion. Ghana's oil reserves and production are declining. Having fallen sharply from the 2019 peaks due to ageing fields, lack of new investments and reduced exploration. Key indicators of the decline are production drop from a high 71 million barrels in 2019 to 48 million barrels in 2024. Oil revenues have fallen by over 50 per cent.

Mr Speaker, to arrest the decline and improve offtake, GNPC plans to undertake some projects in 2026 at the Great Jubilee Field, Tweneboa-Enyenra-Ntomme (TEN) and Sankofa Gye Nyame Field, as listed on page 5 of our report. These projects include: to drill four new development wells and complete five other development wells, to conduct the processing and interpretation of 580 square kilometres of ocean bottom load seismic data. With these projects, Mr Speaker, we expect to see a recovery and return to the 2019 oil production level.

To conclude, Mr Speaker, page 9 of our report indicates the focus of GNPC. GNPC's key priorities in 2016 include arresting the oil production decline, driving oil and gas exploration and production growth, exploration drilling

in the Voltaian Basin, securing gas investments, strengthening organisational capacity and proactively engaging with stakeholders. With these few words, Mr Speaker, I urge the House to adopt the report. Thank you.

**Mr Michael Kwasi Aidoo (NPP — Oforikrom):** Mr Speaker, thank you for the opportunity to contribute to the report. Global demand outlook indicates that the world oil demand growth is expected at 4.5 per cent between 2026 to 2027. Whilst oil demand is growing internationally, in Ghana, our oil production is declining, and because of that, it is important that we look at the investments that GNPC seeks to do in 2026.

Some of the key activities that they want to do is to increase production to 64,300 barrels per day, as well as gas export of 100MMscfd per day. To do this, they will have to drill at least four wells and complete five development wells in 2026. One of the key programmes that GNPC wants to undertake, that I am particularly interested in, is the Tema Gas City project and the Tema gas distribution pipelines. A feasibility study that was done in 2023 showed that the Tema gas demand alone is about 39 MMscfd range. If GNPC is able to do these projects, it will help it to realise the revenue that it seeks to use in developing some of its fields and also supporting its activities.

4:52 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I am also particularly interested in the LNG terminal

acquisition and the research and technology centres that GNPC is developing. I believe if we support GNPC in this direction, they will get the right investments into oil production and increase our oil production.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I support the Report and submit that the House adopts it. Thank you.

**Mr Kofi Arko Nokoe (NDC — Evalue-Ajomoro-Gwira):** Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I rise to speak in support of the adoption of the Report by GNPC. Mr Speaker, this Report reflects a detailed examination and a detailed strategy by GNPC, to revive the petroleum sector. Mr Speaker, amid the challenges and ambitions of this Government is the desire to transition our energy sector from a dominance of liquefied petroleum to gas production. Mr Speaker, strong emphasis is placed on the Voltaian Basin, and the immense potential that this holds for this country is very significant.

The GHCB 01 block, which in all, seeks to arrest production decline and also rebuild reserves. Mr Speaker, this Report targets the intervention in our mature fields. We are talking about Jubilee, TEN and Sankofa Gye Nyame to sustain output and efficiency. In the report, the Research Centre is mentioned, and this is an awesome project that will bring revenue to this country, because everything with research ensures that efficiency and optimal production is done. Mr Speaker, there have been a lot of issues with regard to funding gaps, and that is why I

am so happy that in this work plan, there is a -planned strategy to ensure that receivables and borrowings, and also prudent financial management is embedded in this gas production.

Mr Speaker, I am so happy about the Saltpond Decommission Project. There have been a lot of talk about it, on the environmental hazard that it possesses, and that is why in this Report, the attempt by GNPC to finalise this project is laudable. Mr Speaker, we visited the Research and Technology Centre (RATC), that is being put up on the Spintex Road, and I must applaud the management of GNPC for such an initiative that will yield a lot of benefits to gas exploration and production.

Mr Speaker, in order to shorten my words, I am so happy to have risen to support this report, and I appeal to the House to approve and adopt this report. Thank you very much.

**Mr Kwabena Okyere Darko-Mensah (NPP — Takoradi):** Thank you, Mr Speaker, for this opportunity. In supporting the adoption of this Report, there are a few issues that I wish to bring to your attention. If you look at the global figures for the budget revenues of GH¢1.4 billion, and the expenditure of GH¢1.6 billion, it starts clearly with a deficit of GH¢202 million, which supposes that the recent amendments of the Petroleum Revenue Management Act, 2011, is having its own toil on the budget of GNPC.

Mr Speaker, we know that GNPC is one of the key strategic revenue assets of

this country, and if they have such deficits, it means that a lot of their work programmes cannot be sustained. If you take the bulk of the issues they want to address next year, including their head office, their technology centre, and then major projects like the first drilling in the Voltaian Basin, I believe that it is proper that Government reconsiders its decision of reducing the amount that was going to them, the 15 to 30 per cent, by restoring it back, so that the GNPC will get the money to do the drilling.

Mr Speaker, one of the key issues we need to appreciate is that the Voltaian Basin covers almost 40 per cent of the land mass of this country. After the seismic, I believe that now we are seeing potential. We should never limit GNPC from going all out to drill and get more oil reserves for this country. I believe that we will be doing ourselves a disservice — if we do not continue to spend. Mr Speaker, all over the world, the riskier the agenda, the greater the possibility of generating more revenues for this country.

Mr Speaker, it took Kosmos Energy and Tullow Oil Plc going offshore to discover oil and that discovery has protected us up to this time. In fact, if you take even the Free SHS Programme, a bulk of the budget has come from the oil and gas sector. If you also examine the allocation that was made for the GNPC Foundation, I believe that it is still inadequate. Last year, they promised to give them 8 million, but they paid only 5 million. This year, the plan is to give them 16 million. So clearly, there is a

balance of 3 million that we need to deduct from the 16 million.

Now, that we are going to the Voltaian Basin, with that vast acreage, I recall that last year, I made mention of the fact that even those of us in the coastal areas, who do not have the oil and gas processes onshore, have a lot of difficulty. Now, we are going to drill onshore. Clearly, the amount of money we need to build the social capital for GNPC, for them to go there and drill, if we are not able to do that, it is going to worry us a lot.

Mr Speaker, if you take the deficit issue that came up, GNPC itself had promised to start looking at receivables from a lot of companies and agencies that actually owe them. One of the agencies that they are clear in their mind that owes them is the Government of Ghana, because of the enclave roads that we asked them to do on behalf of the Government.

5:02 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I am particular about this, because if you go to a lot of the Nzema areas, where projects have been inaugurated, GNPC is not paying, and the contractors are not on site. It is because we have virtually made them feel that the deal Government has signed with them will never be paid. So, they are also failing to pay the contractors to do the work for our own people. Now, look at this similar situation happening in the Voltaian Basin. Naturally, if we do not get our acts together, we are going to have a lot of problems.

Mr Speaker, we transport fuel like liquified petroleum gas (LPG) on our roads, and if we take the road from Elubo all the way to Apemanim have some problems, even though it is not even up to 16 years. I believe that in the same way we are asking for concrete roads for the Accra-Kumasi, Expressway, the Takoradi-Accra Road should also have a concrete surfacing, so that it can also last for 50 years.

Mr Speaker, I also believe that the foundation's moneys should be paid to them as quickly as possible, because the foundation owes so many people, including AstroTurf contractors, road contractors, school building contractors, *et cetera*. I therefore believe that it is important that the money that was reduced from 30 per cent to 15 per cent is an issue that the Minister for Finance needs to revisit and make sure that they are paid back, so that they can finance their activities and making sure that they can go forward.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I would like to thank you for this opportunity, and I believe that now that the world is looking at Environmental, Social and Governance (ESGs) issues, all these projects that GNPC is doing should consider environmental, social, and governance issues covering them, especially the Voltaian Basin, so that we can all move forward as a country.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, thank you for the opportunity.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Minority Chief Whip?

**Minority Chief Whip (Mr Frank Annoh-Dompseh):** Mr Speaker, I rise to speak to the Report and to relate to a few concerns on the GNPC. *[Interruption]* I have just started.

Mr Speaker, at the risk of being repetitive, my senior Colleague has contextualised the issues as relayed by the Report. I have read the Report and took time to look at the issues teased out in it. I think for a long time, Parliament has been overly soft, so to speak, in terms of our oversight over the GNPC. The GNPC comes to this House with their work programme, we go through and adopt their Report, and then what? It ends there. A full cycle ensues before another Report is brought. That is why it is necessitating the Minister for Finance's *suo moto* decision, even though it is not justifiable, to reduce the carried and participatory interest support from some 30 per cent to 15 per cent. Why? Because the GNPC themselves have not been participatory and transparent enough.

It is the reason, even though it is something that cannot be justified, I think the Committee on Energy, going into the future, must get a bit more critical on GNPC. They come here and they give us a summary report on corporate social responsibility (CSR) activities undertaken over years, and we only see a bullet of programmes they claim they have undertaken. Yes, we can give them with some credit, a few AstroTurf here and there, but as to whether they bring to this House a detailed report of their corporate social responsibility is a question we should be

asking ourselves. It is a huge concern. So, the Minister for Finance is also looking for revenue, and he gets a low—Mr Speaker, I have not invited Dr Apaak. *[Laughter]* So, the Minister is looking for low-hanging fruit. Unfortunately, he found one with the GNPC.

Let me make pleadings. As much as we want to support the adoption of this Report, there must be further engagement. A slash from 30 per cent to 15 per cent is just not impressive at all. Besides, geological and seismic data that are out there point to the conclusion that Ghana has huge deposits of hydrocarbons. Yes, the data speaks to it, that we have huge prospects of hydrocarbons. So, when they are reducing the carried and participatory interest Fund, what it means is that they are limiting the exploratory activities of the GNPC. We are not in the 80s, when the risks were so huge and corporate bodies and individuals were not motivated to go into oil exploration. Now, they have blazed a trail. The potential, confirmation and data are all there.

So, we cannot, as my senior Colleague, the Hon Darko-Mensah said, we must impress on and convince the Minister for Finance to be a bit charitable. At least, let us give them the benefit of the doubt by giving them a second chance. We cannot take away the money. Slashing from 30 per cent to 15 per cent is something we have to look at again. What it means is that the GNPC will be pushed to the wall where they will only resort to borrowing to do exploration. It does not make economic

sense to go and borrow to do exploration where you have funds generated by the same body. So that would be my first pleading.

Unfortunately, the Minister is not here. I wish we can get the Minister. Mr Speaker, kindly impress upon the Hon Majority Chief Whip to get the Minister for Finance, he must listen to this conversation. The Minister is not here and his Deputy is not here. The GNPC is an important state institution.

Again, if we look at the GNPC Act, GNPC is mandated to reduce negative impact of environmental destruction. The impact of environmental destruction is something they are mandated by their own Act to do. Clearly, if you do a profile of their environmental activities and intervention, it is negative. Of course, they do the environmental impact assessment and then the outcome in terms of what they should do, they do not do it. And it is worrying. The Hon Ranking Member of the Committee on Energy is here. If what I am saying is not true, he should tell me. If I have the attention of the Vice Chairperson.

So, we must devote some attention to the GNPC. There is a lot of potential at the GNPC, and they can generate a lot of revenue to fund even their Big Push. The Big Push in which they pride themselves so much, GNPC can be a good source of revenue to support the Big Push. So, we must get a bit critical and be able to deal with these matters.

Now, because they are reducing the carried and participatory interest, what is

resulting is that their deficit is widening; GNPC's annual deficit is widening. In 2005, they recorded US\$124.7, some US\$124.78 million as deficit. Then, in 2026, they are anticipating US\$214.14 million as deficit. So, the deficit is widening by the year, and GNPC is not a body that should be recording such deficit.

Mr Speaker, I dare say that even though we would want to encourage Members to support the adoption of this Report, aspects of the funding, the necessary oxygen that is supported to prosecute exploration activities of GNPC being reduced, cannot be countenanced by this House. And the Minister is one of our own.

Mr Speaker, I implore you to give some consequential directive that the Committee must go back. We will adopt the Report consequent on the Committee going back to sit with the Minister for Finance, for if they cannot give us 30 per cent, at least they should give us 20 to 25 per cent. He cannot take away everything and just leave out only 15 per cent which will undermine the exploration activities of GNPC. Are we saying that we do not have more hydrocarbons? In fact, there are more hydrocarbon discoveries across the country, and we cannot limit GNPC's exploration activities.

5:12 p.m.

Mr Speaker, I am very emotional because I do not get why the Minister is taking away all these funds. We do not

have hydrocarbons at Adoagyiri, but I know that more discoveries have been made in the Volta Region. We should be seen to be exploiting it for our benefit and to support their "Big Push". Anytime we mention the "Big Push", the Minister for Roads is happy.

So, these will be my observations. I know you are not a fan of giving consequential directives, but for this one, Mr Speaker, I beg you in the name of God. The Committee on Energy must further engage the Minister for Finance. My problem is that the Minister is reducing their revenue generation from 30 to 15 per cent, and he is taking the money to the Consolidated Fund. Now, this Fund is what they use for exploration. And because the seismic data shows that we have more potential for more hydrocarbons, they should be doing more exploration to explore and discover more oil. Therefore, the discovery of more oil means more revenue.

Mr Speaker, I know I have convinced you. The Vice Chairperson and Ranking Member of the Committee on Energy are here. They should go back to engage the Minister for Finance. At least, if they can give them 30 or 20 per cent, that should be enough. But to slash away such a huge amount would not be acceptable to those of us on this Side of the House.

Mr Speaker, I pray that you accede to my call and help salvage GNPC, as the fundamental reason for its formation is

exploration. If I am wrong, someone should let me know. And if their fundamental role and function are going to be curtailed, then we must as a House pay attention and ensure we deal with this matter.

With these words, Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Richard Acheampong.

**Mr Richard Acheampong (NDC — Bia East):** Mr Speaker, thank you. I rise in support of the approval of the work plan of GNPC for the year 2026.

I was not getting the drift of the Minority Chief Whip. On one breath, he was blaming GNPC; on the other, he was blaming the Ministry of Finance for slashing their foundation resources up to 15 per cent. The issue at stake is the resources allocated to them. What were they using the money for? We are calling on the new leadership of GNPC to change course. Yes, we are resetting the GNPC.

GNPC has constructed more Astroturf in this country than any other institution. Is that their mandate? Mr Speaker, for more than 15 years, we heard about the Voltaian Basin project. As we speak, nothing has been done about it. Every year, an allocation is made to the Voltaian Basin Project. Do we have oil from the Voltaian Basin? Instead of drilling new wells so that we can get

value for money, they are just constructing Astroturf. And after the rains set in, Mr Speaker, about 70 per cent of them have been washed off. We cannot even find them. So, we are resetting the GNPC.

Mr Speaker, yesterday, we considered Other Government Obligations and then, as part of the earmarked funds, an allocation of GH¢2,626,630,460 has been allocated to GNPC. The Minister stated that if they present a strong case for the Voltain Basin development, another allocation could be made for them. But as we speak now, we will not give them the money to go and construct Astroturf. It is not their mandate. So, the Committee should come back to the House and show us that they have done their oversight work; they have monitored their activities, and now, we have a new GNPC in place so that another allocation can be given to them in the mid-year. But the old GNPC, that old story, we will not repeat it. The Minister is trying to ensure we put our money where our mouth is. We cannot give what we do not have.

So, the 2.6 billion that has been allocated to them, let us ensure that they use it for the purpose for which it has been allocated. At the end of the day, we can come together as a House and make a good case for them. But the Ranking Member was just dancing around the issue, as if he were unaware of the matter. He knows the problems. We are resetting GNPC. So, in 2026, a new story



will be told that we have a new GNPC, and more allocations will be made to GNPC.

Mr Speaker, I thank you very much for the opportunity. Yes.

**Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin):** Mr Speaker, I have had the opportunity of reading the report of the Committee. I find it very strange to hear the Deputy Majority Whip argue that the decision by the GNPC Foundation, as part of its corporate social responsibility, to promote sports and inculcate a culture of reading, is not a priority. Over the years, GNPC Foundation took steps to construct libraries to encourage many youths to have access to reading materials, study and improve their reading skills.

Mr Speaker, we know a lot of our youth are involved in sports, and community sporting activities are of great concern to stakeholders like us, the political leaders. Even in sports, the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, which is being considered by this House, if we read this Bill critically, it looks at ways of raising sufficient funds to support sporting activities.

5:22 p.m.

Therefore, if GNPC in the past took this mandate as a major interest, why would they say that in a new dispensation, they are going to do away with the promotion of sports? When AstroTurf are constructed in

communities, they are not for a particular political party, and we are aware that, within the last eight years, GNPC's construction of AstroTurf benefited many constituencies, and it had nothing to do with who belongs to which constituency or not.

So, Mr Speaker, it is very strange to hear that deliberately the Ghanaian youth, who depend on this AstroTurf for athletics, sporting activities, and regular exercises, are being denied.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Member made a very strange submission. He said that AstroTurf are being washed away by rain. This is the House of Parliament; for partisan reasons, an Hon Member cannot just get up and make a sweeping statement as if it is well-founded in any serious fact.

Mr Speaker, I am surprised that, as this Government has introduced a Bill in this House to promote sports, the same Government is denying our communities of sporting facilities, and the Hon Member from the Majority Side is proud of this, that they have cancelled the vision of the foundation for promoting sporting activities in our various communities.

Mr Speaker, the youth of this country, I believe, are listening and they have heard. The youth in our various communities, of course, the Government cannot construct a stadium for a

community in Winneba. But at least, if GNPC Foundation had, as part of its corporate social responsibility to support a community with an AstroTurf, today, the Government is saying that community sporting facilities are no longer a priority. Today, this Government is saying that AstroTurf are being cancelled. Today, this Government is saying that corporate social responsibility, which is a platform and an avenue to support activities that will help community development, can no longer be a priority, and it was said by no less a person than Mr Acheampong, who speaks from the Majority Frontbench.

Mr Speaker, he was saying to this —

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, ordinarily, once you mention his name, I will give the floor to Mr Acheampong.

**Mr Acheampong:** Mr Speaker, in my submission, I said this in a contest. I said it is not in their mandate to do those things. If we check the Sports Budget, 50 AstroTurf have been allocated. So, GNPC has a mandate to develop the Voltaian Basin and to drill more wells; that was the point I was making. So, he cannot invite the youth against me by saying that —*[Laughter]*.

So, Mr Speaker, I did not say that the Hon Minority Leader—That part should be expunged from our records, and he should apologise to his good Friend. We came to this House together. The two of

us started our parliamentary work from the Finance Committee; we have travelled a long way and the rest is history. *[Laughter]*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, he said he never said those things, having given him the floor. So, take his concern on board and proceed.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, the records will have it, without any contest, that the last eight years, that is the Akufo-Addo Government, encouraged GNPC to get certain priority projects done, and through GNPC Foundation, libraries and AstroTurf were very key on the agenda. Today, in this Report, AstroTurf are no longer a priority.

Mr Speaker, GNPC constructed clinics and schools but today, we are being told that they are no longer a priority. But, while communities are being denied these important social amenities, the Report, which is before us, states as follows:

“Revenue is being projected at US\$1.43 billion, as against an expenditure of US\$1.6 billion, resulting in a deficit of over US\$200 million.”

Mr Speaker, I thought the apostles of reset had told us that things were being done differently. How can they spend what they do not have? Their revenue is

projected at US\$1.4 billion, yet they want to spend US\$1.6 billion; meanwhile, they are cutting expenditure on infrastructure that will go to the benefit of the ordinary Ghanaian, because people want tangible benefits from the oil revenue. If they construct a school, a library, an AstroTurf, or a clinic, they will be helping the community; yet, all of these are being denied. If we read the Report, from what it is saying, these are no longer the priorities; they are not going to focus on all of these. So, the expenditure that exceeds revenue, what exactly would they spend on?

Mr Speaker, we are concerned, and if the Hon Second Deputy Majority Whip decides to be proud of the decision by the Government to take away these social benefits, and he comes to say that under the Reset they have done away with these projects, and he says so proudly, he is not looking at the social costs to the nation.

Mr Speaker, history will judge their actions. I rest my case.

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, I urge Colleagues to approve and adopt the Report of the Committee on Energy on the 2026 Work Programme of the Ghana National Petroleum Corporation (GNPC).

Mr Speaker, what we have before us is not a Budget; it is the work programme. The Budget itself has

already been approved. What we are looking at is the work programme.

5:32 p.m.

Highlighted in the conclusion of the Committee is this:

“Together with its partners, GNPC’s 2026 work programme and budget sets out a strategic plan to strengthen the petroleum sector amid global economic and energy transition challenges. GNPC projects revenues of US\$1.433 billion and expenditures of US\$1.635 billion, leaving a US\$202 million deficit.”

Mr Speaker, when you are established as an organisation with a core mandate, and in implementing your mandate, you have a deficit of US\$202 million. As a wise administrator, if one wanted to make cuts, where will they be making the cuts? Will they be making the cuts in the areas related to their core mandate? Or they will be making the cuts in the areas that do not relate to their core mandate? Rational leadership will make a cut in the area that is not their core mandate.

What is not their core mandate? The area of Corporate Social Responsibility. When they argue as if it is the only place that ordinary citizens can benefit in terms of oil revenues, that is also not true. The oil revenues have been used to support the Budget. Indeed, in this Chamber just last week, it was argued that it was out of the oil revenues that we were funding

Free Senior High Education. So, the oil revenues are already financing social sector issues such as education, health, housing, *et cetera*. Let us not create the impression that it is from this corporate social allocation in GNPC's budget that social issues will be financed. When my Colleague argues that the organisation is being reset to focus on its core mandate, and not to go spending money in areas that are not related to its responsibility, he is not suggesting that the youth should not have AstroTurfs. He is also not suggesting that clinics that were built by GNPC are not important, but GNPC must learn to focus on what its core mandate is. That is what the Minister seeks to do by realigning resources so that more resources will go into its core mandate of exploration, of supporting the extraction and production of oil so that Ghana can rake in more revenues from its oil sector.

Mr Speaker, while I will join the Committee in urging that a lot more should be put into corporate social responsibility, I do not want it presented as if the argument for pushing GNPC to focus on its core corporate responsibility is an argument against supporting the youth of this country with AstroTurfs. As indicated, this Government is taking measures to ensure that resources are available to the sports sector to invest in infrastructure. Indeed, today, we just took the Ghana Sports Fund Bill through the Consideration Stage, and we explored other avenues for raising funds to support sports infrastructure

investment. We are taking steps in a more sustainable way to finance AstroTurfs across the country, stadium construction, and general infrastructure for athletics and all the other sporting activities. We are on course in that direction, but we also want GNPC to focus on its core mandate.

On that note, I urge Colleagues to adopt the Report, but I also want to add my voice to the Committee, which says that we should also in the future consider increasing the allocation to the GNPC Foundation. The Foundation does not only do AstroTurfs, it does clinics. We may not think that AstroTurfs is what they should be doing, but at least clinics and others in the communities where they are operating will also create the kind of social capital that they need to be able to work effectively in those communities. On that note, I urge Colleagues to adopt the Report. Thank you, Mr Speaker.

*Question put and the Motion agreed to.*

*Resolved accordingly.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Majority Leader?

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, we may take the item numbered 2.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, *Order Paper Addendum*, the item numbered 2.

## PAPERS

*By the Chairperson of the Committee*

Report of the Committee on Education on the Simon Diedong Dombo University of Business and Integrated Development Studies (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Report of the Committee on Education on the C.K. Tedam University of Technology and Applied Sciences (Amendment) Bill, 2025

Report of the Committee on Education on the Akenten Appiah-Menka University of Skills Training and Entrepreneurial Development (Amendment) Bill, 2025

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes?

**Minority Leader (Osahen Alexander Kwamena Afenyo-Markin):** Mr Speaker, I beg to request the Minister to provide a short explanation to— *[Interruption]*— Yes, I need that. I mean, you have raised this matter of changing— The whole essence of this is to change the name of the university.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, it is the person who presented the Report that should give a short explanation. It is not the Minister.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, but he is leaving. The Committee Chairperson is leaving. That is why I wanted the Minister to do so since he is a sponsor.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, but I do not have the power to mention a person other than the one who presented the Report to give the explanation. We have to go by the rules.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, since the sector Minister is here and he is a sponsor of the Bill, may I humbly plead that in the absence of the Chairperson and the Vice Chairperson, the Minister assist this House with this. As soon as I got up to make the application, the Chairperson of the Committee rushed out. The cameras would bear me out. He rushed out. I have not sighted the Vice Chairperson in the Chamber.

5:42 p.m.

If he is, then that is all right. The Vice-Chairperson is here? I said I have not sighted him. If it is so, by using “he rushed out”, amount to imputing improper motive. He left immediately I got up with the application. So, Mr Speaker, I am told the Vice-Chairperson is here. So, in the absence of the

Chairperson, let the Vice-Chairperson do the needful.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** I strongly believe that after the presentation of the Report of the Committee, we will come to a stage where the principles will be debated. At that point, the request being made by the Minority Leader will be acceded to. The deals have been introduced earlier, so, if it were to be at that point that he made this request, we would have acceded to the request.

Therefore, Hon Members, the Papers in the item numbered 2 at page 1 of the *Order Paper Addendum*, laid by the Chairperson of the Committee have been duly presented and are for distribution to Hon Members.

Yes, Majority Chief Whip?

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I believe that we can now deal with the Motion numbered 31 on the original *Order Paper*, if it pleases you.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Minister for Sports and Recreation, the Motion numbered 31.

## **BILL — THIRD READING**

### **Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025**

**Minister for Sports and Recreation (Mr Kofi Iddie Adams):** Mr Speaker, I beg to *move*:

That the Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 be now read the Third time.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, the prior agreement with your blessings were that we should do other Businesses. Of course, we are not opposed to taking it, but other Businesses should be prosecuted. Then, eventually, we will take it. The Chief Whip has other Businesses to be taken. He should navigate properly and let us do all those Businesses. This one, we have finished everything. It is the Third Reading and we can take it. Hon Kofi Adams cannot rush Parliament. Ghana has qualified for the World Cup, yes, we know, but he cannot rush us.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Chief Whip, I do not take it as the Minister for Sports and Recreation rushing Parliament.

Hon Members, Motion moved. Any seconder?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** He has not moved the Motion.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** I have listened to the Motion moved. Any seconder?

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Did he move the Motion? We will call for *Hansard* tomorrow. I pleaded with him and he just sat down. It is all right.

**Mr Rockson-Nelson Etse Kwami Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, I beg to second the Motion.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

The Ghana Sports Fund Bill, 2025 –  
*read the Third time and passed.*

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, we have one more Report to take and that is the Report of the House Committee. We had agreed that we would do that at Closed Sitting. So, Mr Speaker, if it pleases you, we want to do that.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, my Friend who is the Chairperson of the House Committee had given notification. But Order 60, calls on you for this to be done. If it has to be done at Closed Sitting in respect of Order 60, then it has to be done that — “The Speaker may, in consultation with the House and having regard to ...”. So, I guess we have to relate to the Speaker to direct us if we are coming under Order 60. The Leader may have to reference. But I am not opposed to that. Mr Speaker, we are not opposed. We can proceed.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** If the House would recall, in fact, this was to have been taken yesterday, but the Business of the House was such that it could not be accommodated. Mr Speaker, the indication is that the Report of the Finance Committee is ready. So, we would love to lay that before we do the Closed Sitting. That would be the Motion numbered 36 on the original *Order Paper*.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** The Motion numbered 36 cannot be a Paper. That is Second Reading.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, we want to pray that we take the item on *Order Paper Addendum 3*.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, I do not have *Order Paper Addendum 3*. I have *Order Paper Addendum* and I have *Order Paper Addendum 2*. I had yesterday questioned my Colleagues that the printing of —

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, they are bringing you a copy and it is also on the console.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, I want to pray with you. Can you listen to me? This is *Addendum 3*; I do not have a problem. But they could have added *Addendum 3* to *Addendum 2*. *Addendum 3* is not on the console.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** You indicated yesterday that you are an environmentalist.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, would you hear me out?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** I am just supporting you, that you indicated clearly that you are an environmentalist.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** Mr Speaker, I am not opposed. They should proceed and lay.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Very well. Presentation of Papers, *Order*

*Paper Addendum 3. Chairperson of the Committee?*

### PAPER

*By the Chairperson of the Committee*

Report of the Budget Committee on Appropriation (No.2) Bill 2025.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** On this note, I would beg to take —Yes, let me hear you, Hon Chief Whip.

**Mr Annoh-Dompreh:** The Appropriation Bill was laid?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes. It was laid and referred to the Committee. The Committee is now bringing their Report.

5:52 p.m.

The Report must be distributed for Members to go through, then we can do justice to it.

On this note, Hon Members, I will take a few minutes' suspension.

Hon Members, the House is temporarily suspended.

5:54 p.m. — *Sitting suspended.*

6:34 p.m.— *Sitting resumed.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Majority Leader, do we take the Motion numbered 36?

*[Pause]*

**Mr Ayariga:** Hon Kwarteng is Chair of the Committee. If he is ready, we can take the report of the Committee on Appropriation. We can take *Order Paper Addendum 3.*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** *Addendum 3* has been exhausted. So, do we do the Appropriation? It is the Motion numbered 36 on the *Order Paper.*

**Mr Ayariga:** 36? No, we have not adopted the Report yet. Mr Speaker, my understanding is that the Report of the Committee was laid.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, that is it. At Second Reading, we consider the Report together with the Explanatory Memorandum.

**Mr Ayariga:** All right, Mr Speaker, let us take item numbered 36. The Report is on the console; in case Members want to contribute, they can check.

Mr Speaker, the Minister for Finance is not here, so the Deputy Minister for Finance, with your indulgence, will move the Motion.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Habib.

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, as much as we want to do this, we want to send notice to the Majority Leader that we need to see the Minister for Finance here. Because the Appropriation is what is going to give him the licence to spend in 2026. So, if he thinks that it is not



important and he is going to be somewhere, we will oppose it. We will raise a lot of issues because we have a lot of problems with the Appropriation, and we want the Minister for Finance to hear them.

We do not think that the Deputy might be able to handle it. So, he can move the Motion for Second Reading, but before we get to the Consideration Stage, the Minister ought to be here. With the Second Reading, after the Motion has been moved, Members will have to give comments. So, the Minister for Finance needs to be here to listen to what they are going to say. With whatever Motion we have moved, without Appropriation, he cannot spend. He would not have any authority to spend. So, wherever the Minister for Finance is, the Majority Leader needs to get him to the Chamber because this is very important to him.

If we do not get the Minister for Finance here, then they should ensure they have about 140 Members here to be able to approve the Appropriation. So, without much ado, Mr Speaker, he can move the Motion for Second Reading.

### **BILL — SECOND READING Appropriation (No.2) Bill, 2025**

**Deputy Minister for Finance (Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem) (MP) on behalf of the Minister for Finance:** Mr Speaker, I beg to move:

That the Appropriation (No.2) Bill, 2025 be now read a Second time.

**Chairperson of the Committee (Mr Kwaku Agyeman Kwarteng):** Mr Speaker, I beg to support the Motion, and in so doing, I present your Committee's Report. I urge *Hansard* to capture the entire Report as having been read.

### **Introduction**

The Appropriation (No. 2) Bill, 2025 was presented and read the first time in the House on Thursday, 18<sup>th</sup> December, 2025. The Bill was subsequently referred to the Budget Committee for consideration and report in accordance with article 179 (2) of the 1992 Constitution and the Standing Orders of the House. This followed the presentation of the Budget Statement and Economic Policy of Government for the 2026 Financial Year by the Minister responsible for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson.

The Committee met and considered the Bill with the Minister for Finance, Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson, Deputy Minister for Finance, Mr Thomas Nyarko Ampem, the Chief Director and a team of other officials from the Ministry of Finance.

The Committee is grateful to the above-mentioned Hon Minister, Hon Deputy Minister and the team of officials for attending upon the Committee.

### **Urgency of the Bill**

The Committee determined and hereby certifies that the Bill is of an urgent nature and may be taken through all the stages of passage in one day in accordance with article 106(13) of the

1992 Constitution and Order 160(4) of the Standing Orders of the House.

## References

The Committee referred to and was guided by the following documents *inter alia* during its deliberations on the Bill:

- The 1992 Constitution of the Republic of Ghana
- The Standing Orders of the Parliament of Ghana, 2024.
- Interpretation Act, 2009 (Act 792)
- The Budget Statement and Economic Policy of the Government of Ghana for the 2026 Financial Year.
- Reports of Parliamentary Committees on the 2026 Annual Estimates for the various Ministries, Departments and Agencies (MDAs) as well as Other Government Obligations.

## Background Information

Pursuant to Article 179 of the Constitution, the Minister responsible for Finance acting on the authority of His Excellency the President has requested the House to approve and authorise the withdrawal of monies from the Consolidated Fund and other funds for the running of the State during the

Financial Year commencing on the 1<sup>st</sup> day of January 2026 and ending on 31<sup>st</sup> day of December 2026.

Upon Parliament's approval of various sums as Budget Estimates for Ministries, Departments and Agencies of Government (MDAs) as well as *Other Government Obligations* for the 2025 Financial Year, it has become imperative that the Minister responsible for Finance be given authority to withdraw such approved funds for the purposes thereof.

## Object of the Bill

Pursuant to article 179 (2) (a) of the Constitution, the Appropriation (No. 2) Bill, 2025 is seeking Parliamentary authority to enable a sum of money not exceeding Three Hundred and Fifty-Seven Billion, One Hundred and Five Million, Six Hundred and Thirty-Nine Thousand and Eighty Ghana Cedis (GH¢357,105,639,080) to be issued from the Consolidated Fund and other public funds during the Financial Year commencing on the 1<sup>st</sup> day of January 2026 and ending on the 31<sup>st</sup> day of December 2026 for the purpose of meeting Government expenditure.

The specific purposes for which the sum shall be appropriated have been specified in the schedules to the Bill, all of them geared towards efficiently and effectively carrying out the services of the Government for the 2026 Financial Year.

The summary of expenditures covered in the Bill is captioned “FIRST SCHEDULE (Section 1)” and attached to this Report as APPENDIX.

## **Observations**

### **Retained Internally Generated Funds**

The Committee observed that Ministries, Departments and Agencies shall be permitted to retain and use an amount of Eighteen Billion, One Hundred and Eighty Million, Seven Hundred and Seventeen Thousand, Six Hundred and Thirteen Ghana Cedis (GH¢18,180,717,613) of Internally Generated Funds (IGFs) during the 2026 Financial Year.

### **Other Government Obligations**

Out of the total amount of GH¢357,105,639,080 to be appropriated for the 2026 financial year, Two Hundred and Twenty-Two Billion, Nine Hundred and Ninety-Six Million, Nine Hundred and Eleven Thousand, Five Hundred and Seventy-Nine Ghana Cedis (GH¢222,996,911,579) would constitute payments of Other Government Obligations while the rest would cover discretionary payments.

### **Repeal**

The Bill repeals the Appropriation Act, 2025 (Act 1126).

Act 1126 authorised the withdrawal of moneys from the Consolidated Fund and other public funds for the implementation of the Budget for the 2025 Financial Year.

## **Recommendation and Conclusion**

The Committee recommends that the sum of money not exceeding Three Hundred and Fifty-Seven Billion, One Hundred and Five Million, Six Hundred and Thirty-Nine Thousand and Eighty Ghana Cedis (GH¢357,105,639,080) be approved and authorised to be issued from the Consolidated Fund and other public funds for the purposes of financing Government operations during the Financial Year commencing the 1<sup>st</sup> day of January 2026 and ending on the 31<sup>st</sup> day of December 2026.

The Committee thus recommends to the House to pass the Appropriation (No. 2) Bill, 2025 into law in accordance with article 106(13) of the 1992 Constitution and Order 160(4) of the Standing Orders of the House.

Respectfully Submitted.

Mr Speaker, the Committee determined that this ought to be taken under a certificate of urgency, and so we recommend same to the House. You would see, Mr Speaker, from Paragraph 5 of the Committee’s Report, that we have stated the observations we made.

6:12 p.m.

The Appropriation Bill is essentially in two parts. On one hand, we have the other Government Obligations, which, strictly speaking, ought to have been the statutory expenditures, and then we have the discretionary expenditures as well. This Bill also seeks to repeal the Appropriation Act, 2025 (Act 1126).

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, Motion moved. The Chairman of the Committee has also presented the Report; it is now for the consideration of the House.

Hon Members, the debate may arise on the basis of the explanatory memorandum and the Report of the Committee. The floor is now open for debate.

Yes, Dr T. A. K. Mahama?

**Dr T. A. K. Mahama:** Mr Speaker, before us today is the Appropriation (N0. 2) Bill, 2025, but prelude to that is a report emanating from the Budget Committee recommending that this House should approve a whopping sum of GH¢357,105,609,080 for the Hon Minister for Finance to spend for a single year, 2026.

Mr Speaker, a single-year expenditure, a colossal sum of GH¢357 billion, I am making this point so forceful because we will need to

juxtapose that against what they spent last year.

Mr Speaker, this House in 2025 approved for the Hon Minister for Finance an amount of GH¢293,118,026,137. When we match the two, they are asking for a GH¢63 billion increase in expenditure.

Mr Speaker, a Government that is saying it is austere, that they are very prudent with resource management, cannot be calling for this huge jump in expenditure. What is even more startling is the fact that for compensation this year, they want to spend some GH¢90,559,958,860. Last year, do we know how much they spent or requested from this House? It was GH¢76 billion. This, again, is a huge jump.

Mr Speaker, they should take their calculators and do the mathematics. The President promised a 9 per cent salary increase. A 9 per cent increment in salary should not translate to GH¢90 billion for compensation, unless, of course, they are saying that in 2026, there are going to be a lot of Committees that are going to be drinking teas, and those Committees would actually be in charge of drinking tea —[Laughter] — that huge jump does not translate to the 9 per cent that the President promised the good people of Ghana.

Mr Speaker, when we look at the interest payment, even with an IMF-supported programme, they are saying

that they want to dedicate an amount of GH¢57 billion for the purpose of paying interest. We do know that, under the IMF-supported programme, in 2026, payment of interest is actually not much of a burden, but their payment of interest is even more than what they are spending in their capital expenditure. The Big Push Agenda is GH¢30 billion, and they are actually putting GH¢57 billion for the purposes of paying interest.

Mr Speaker, is it the case of this Government that even with the renegotiation and with the haircut they are proposing to even give commercial trade lenders —

Mr Speaker, before this House, these people are proposing a haircut. They are proposing a haircut for commercial lenders, creditors, and on top of that, they want to do some GH¢57 billion payment of interest. The numbers do not match because on one hand, they are proposing a haircut to commercial creditors, and on the other hand, they are asking us to approve GH¢57 billion for you to pay interest; the numbers do not match, and the Hon Minister will have to look at the numbers once more.

Mr Speaker, what is more of an issue is their transfers to social spending. We are in a particular difficulty; people in rural areas, market women, people who are vulnerable, people who are widows, are not able to make ends meet, even with their so-called single-digit inflation.

Mr Speaker, there is an allocation of GH¢5 billion for social spending. A Government that is supposed to be social democratic in nature, a Government that is supposed to support the vulnerable, a Government that prides itself that it cares for the downtrodden, they are allocating some GH¢3 billion to social spending, and then they are allocating some GH¢90 billion to pay yourselves; this is not good economic management, GH¢90 billion is supposed to run Government machinery. How do they allocate such an amount to pay themselves?

Mr Speaker, lastly on capital expenditure, they are saying that in this Appropriation Bill, we should approve GH¢57 billion for capital expenditure, and they want to finance that by borrowing some GH¢45 billion from the local economy. Government is competing with the private sector, and Government is competing with people who are supposed to be—Definitely, we expect interest rates to jump, because in a single year, the Government wants to borrow GH¢45 billion from the local economy. Is this the kind of economic management that they say is going to turn the corner?

Mr Speaker, GH¢45 billion is not a small amount. Let us take even last year, they did not borrow up to this, but the private sectors were crowded out, and people in the private sector could not access capital. Even with a lower interest rate, the banks could not advance capital

to them. Today, they want to borrow GH¢45 billion from the domestic market.

Mr Speaker, they are also trying to go international to borrow. They are not only borrowing internally; they want to borrow internationally. As if the GH¢45 billion is not enough, they want to go and borrow some GH¢12 billion from outside. This is a Government that is interested in borrowing. I thought they said before this House that Mr Ken Ofori-Atta was interested in Bonds, and they mentioned certain bonds such as samurai bonds, green bonds, and other bonds. They used these names to ridicule Mr Ken Ofori-Atta.

6:54 p.m.

But today, they are borrowing some GH¢12 billion, even under the International Monetary Fund (IMF) programme. The IMF is telling them that within the fiscal year, they should not do more than US\$100 million under the ceiling. But they are doing some GH¢12 billion. They are trying to use an exchange rate of GH¢12. If you do their mathematics, in order to stay with the US\$100 million, they are doing an exchange rate of some GH¢12.

Meanwhile, their Bank of Ghana is even telling them that it is GH¢11. These people will say one thing and do another. I do not understand, and I think this House should not support, that under this crawling economy that the private sector

is already crowded out, we should allow the Government to go and borrow GH¢45 billion from the domestic market. This House should not tolerate that. Even if we agree that the Government should borrow, the Government will have to look at that. What is even more interesting — the Minister for Finance has joined. They told us that they wanted to use artificial intelligence to increase revenue collection, and they have made us approve international contracts that will allow them to rake in more revenue through the use of artificial intelligence. On top of that, they want to borrow some GH¢45 billion from the domestic economy, some GH¢12 billion from foreign countries. I do not think that this Appropriation Bill that they are asking us to approve would actually help the good people of Ghana in terms of addressing our underlying issues.

Mr Speaker, lastly, this is a Government that says that the economy was badly managed. On top of the GH¢357 billion expenditure, they want to grow at 5 per cent. What kind of expenditure is this? Expenditure that will not spur growth? Expenditure that will not translate to GDP growth is not expenditure. Mr Speaker, capital expenditure should translate into the growth of the economy. They have spent GH¢57 billion, but the growth of the economy is even shrinking as compared to the growth in 2024. I do not think that they are happy with this record. I am not sure any member of the Government is

happy with such a record. If they want to appreciate these figures, they should try to divide the numbers by the number of constituents they have and they will appreciate that this is a huge, gargantuan, colossal amount that this Government wants to put down the drain without any growth.

Mr Speaker, with these few words, I think that in all sincerity and fairness, my conscience will not allow me to support the approval of this Appropriation for the Ministry of Finance. I thank you so much for the opportunity.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, order!

I will give the floor to Mr Isaac Adongo.

**Mr Isaac Adongo (NDC — Bolgatanga Central):** Mr Speaker, thank you very much for the opportunity. We have to live long to know that wonders will never end. In 2023, my Colleague, then working in the Office of the Vice President, the head of the Economic Management Team, came to this House and approved interest payments of GH¢115 billion. Today, he is crying over an interest of GH¢50 billion. Is that not surprising? GH¢115 billion was approved in this House for interest payment last year, just 2023. Yet, these people are now surprised that interest payment that is 50 per cent less is wrong. What type of *jandam* mathematics and finance is that?

When they complain that a Government is going to draw down loans that they have contracted for the Government, those loans were contracted by the New Patriotic Party (NPP), and we are going to draw down to finance development. He is not happy that the loans that he contracted, we are now drawing them down. So what does he want to do with the loans? Should we go and cancel them? Those loans that he is complaining about are loans that were contracted by the NPP Government, for which we are drawing down. He should go and look at the financing in the budget; those are project loans and not Eurobonds. It is very surprising that they have an issue with the loans they contracted, loans that are being drawn down.

Mr Speaker, these were the descendants of the people who came here and were borrowing US\$3 billion a year in the Eurobond market. When was the last time they heard Eurobond market in this Parliament? Yet, they are here. People who run this country area ground. People who declared to the world that Ghana should be declared bankrupt, and they spent two years to get a certificate of bankruptcy for this country, these are the people who are complaining over GH¢12 billion. Mr Speaker, is that not surprising?

Then again, I now understand how they never managed to run this economy. Let people learn that social spending includes education; education is social

spending. Maybe some people must go and learn what social spending is about. Health is social spending. People do not understand that when we say social spending, it is not the same as Livelihood Empowerment Against Poverty (LEAP). LEAP is just a subset, just a small minute part of social spending.

My good Friend, pay attention. I am speaking to him and he is distracted. Why is he now hiding? *[Laughter]*

Mr Speaker, when a Government in the Budget allocates GHC29 billion to health, that is social spending. That is for the vulnerable. Mr Speaker, we were in this country when GETFund was constituted into a debt payment entity. All they were doing was spend GHC2 billion a year just to serve a Daakye Bonds. Today, GETFund is getting GHC9 billion not to pay debt, but to finance education. Somebody is here talking about social spending. My good Friend, take the Budget and read social spending properly. Social spending is not LEAP; social spending is not Capitation Grants and; social spending is not School Feeding Programme. Those are just the minute part of social spending. They must understand the bigger envelope for social spending so that they do not mislead our people to think that social spending is just all about LEAP. *[Hear! Hear!]*

Mr Speaker, for the first time, I have heard somebody, a very learned person, measure deficit by nominal value. What

type of economics is that where he measures deficit by nominal values and he has never heard GHC45 billion before? We were in this country, when the nominal value of deficit was more than the total revenue in our country in 2022. In 2024, what was their deficit? It was more than this. If they are counting nominal values, they were doing GHC60 billion in 2024. Fast forward two years later, somebody is doing GHC45 billion. When they should rather be going up by the way they were running the economy, and they are saying they have never heard that before.

Mr Speaker, compensation. My good Friend says that he does not understand why his salary is being factored in the Budget. Does he not know that money is his salary? Mr Speaker, if they do not want salary, they should just tell us, we will cut it. These are salary increases for him, an Article 71 office holder.

7:04 p.m.

How does payment of salary amount to drinking of tea? Is drinking of tea salary? Is drinking of tea compensation? When we say compensating, it is not about compensating as we understand it. It is about wages and salaries. For the first time, I am hearing such a learned person refer to compensation as tea party. How does that amount to tea party? Let us be serious in our country. It is about our salary. If we do not pay him for one month, Ghana will hear us.



But Mr Speaker, in addition to that, we are recruiting the young men that they left unemployed into the security services. How do they expect us to pay them? We are recruiting the unemployed young men into the army. He himself is looking around to find opportunities for the people of Walewale, but he says that we should not provide for them.

We are recruiting people to run the affairs of Government at the Ministry of Education and Ministry of Health. The nurses that they did not recruit, we are recruiting them. They had over 11,000 people they recruited into the Ghana Health Service. They did not even put them on the payroll, and we have put them on the payroll. Where do they think we should pay them from? In education, they recruited over 13,000 teachers and did not put them on the payroll, but we have catered to pay for them, and they have a problem with that.

Mr Speaker, Ghanaians should understand these people. They never liked Ghanaians. The unemployed youth should now understand why they are unemployed, because they never want to pay them. They do not want them to be employed and be paid to take care of their families. Mr Speaker, this Budget is meant to make sure that the youth that are unemployed find something to do, and we will pay them.

Mr Speaker, the Hon Member was complaining about capital expenditure. We are in this country when they declared year of roads and came here with roads budget of GH¢2 billion in this Parliament, and deceived the people of Ghana, that somehow they were going to fix our roads with GH¢2 billion. We

have budgeted for GH¢30 billion, and they have an issue with it. What type of people are these?

Somebody says that he does not understand why there is international borrowing. He should be happy that there is a government that the international community trusts and have confidence in them and will lend to them. They were sacked away from the international capital market. You ran this country to a junk status, and they were rated by all rating agencies into junk. That is why they never gave them money and stopped them from borrowing US\$3 billion a year on the European market. This young man, Dr Ato Forson has cleaned up their mess. Mr Speaker, this young man has made sure that our rating is now up there and the people trust us and they want to give us money. They do not want that?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Adongo, conclude.

*[Some Hon Members of the Minority chanted]*

Hon Members, let there be order.

**Mr Adongo:** Mr Speaker, it is becoming very clear that they do not like anything good about Ghana. They brought us a bankrupt economy and arrived with a bankrupt certificate tied to their neck. They made Ghana man of straw, and today, we have raised Ghana to a status where people are now calling us to come and take money, and they have an issue with that.

Mr Speaker, I think that the *Jandam* economics will die. It is becoming very clear that they do not have anything to say about the management of the economy. The management of the economy is very clear. Only recently, despite everything we told them here, they think that when they continue to tell untruth, it will become the truth. In managing this economy, we came to meet foreign reserves of US\$8 billion. They claim that we have pumped US\$10 billion. So, if we have US\$8 billion that we came to meet and we pump US\$10 billion, do we end up with US\$12 billion? I mean, what type of *Jandam* analysis are these? And all they are doing is that they instigate these journalists to be waiting for them at the entrance. They wait for them at the entrance just so they can get *TikTok* bite. How can we meet reserves of US\$8 billion, pump US\$10 billion of that, and we have almost US\$12 billion sitting at the Bank of Ghana? We must be magicians. We must be magicians to have done that.

The truth is that the economy generated that forex. The cocoa farmer that produced cocoa that the Minority, when in government, went and sold and brought only US\$500 million into Ghana within six months, when we sold them, we brought US\$1.8 billion in six months. That is US\$1.3 billion more. Why? Do they want us to give it to Dr Forson to go and put in his house? We would give it to the people who need it to import things into our country. Gold Board alone is giving us US\$9 billion a year, and it is not even a year but now. That money is produced by Ghanaian miners. So, if Ghanaians produce their gold, and we go

and sell it and we bring the forex, do they want us to give it to Chairman Wontumi to keep in Kumasi? We give it to importers, and that is why they are seeing the stability of the cedi.

So, they can shout on top of the roof that we generate forex. These people were borrowing forex and giving it to them. They were borrowing US\$3 billion every year to give it to importers. They borrowed US\$3 billion, organised a *Kenkey* party and gave it to people, meanwhile they had forgotten that they would have to go back for the GHC3 billion, and they would go back into the principal and interest payment. When it arrived, initially they printed GHC80 billion. After that, the person who wanted the US\$3 billion wants it, and they could not give them cedis. *Aye ka*. Then they said they could not pay because they had cedis and not dollars.

At a point, Mr Speaker, our entire forex reserve at the Bank of Ghana could last for 0.8 months; that is less than two weeks. Less than two weeks. If they knew how to raise US\$10 billion, how come they did not have forex? Less than two weeks. Now if we come to Bank of Ghana, our reserve is about US\$12 billion, and they are completely dazed. It is not a fact that all the time they might find something wrong, when there is nothing wrong. My good friend, do not try to criticise when there is nothing to criticise.

Mr Speaker, I want to tell my Colleagues that this is a Budget of good news. One of their own, who sat in the front row here, today is the Minister for

Finance and is putting Ghana on the pedestal. He requires your support to continue to deliver the good news to our people. That can only happen if the Appropriation Bill is approved and the money is made available to the Minister. Mr Speaker, the amount of money the Hon Kabiru is complaining about, does he have it sitting in his office that he is going to give to Dr Forson? He is going to raise it himself. So, when he raises the money he should not spend it?

A good government raises the money from Ghana and spends the money in Ghana. By the time we are done, I am sure the people of Ghana will understand what a good budget looks like.

Mr Speaker, I rest my case and encourage my colleagues to support the adoption of the report.

7:14 p.m.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.  
[Hear! Hear!]

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Majority Leader?

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, I think it is the turn of Leadership, because as you know, Parliament has organised an event and we have invited Ghanaians. They are sitting out there waiting for us. We have debated the Budget, debated the various sectoral allocations and debated the principle. So, whatever we are saying now is a repetition of what we have already said. Nothing new is being said,

and nothing that will be said will change the figures. [Hear! Hear!] After all the new and wonderful things that Hon Adongo has said, I do not think anybody has anything more to add. So, on this point, Leadership will take a bite and you put the question.

**First Deputy Minority Whip (Alhaji Habib Iddrisu):** Thank you, Mr Speaker.

This Parliament is not a Parliament of one Side and it is a Parliament of precedents. It is a Parliament of rules. What the Hon Majority Leader is proposing is very alien to this House. It is alien in the sense that, the Hon Majority Leader is a sixth-time Member of Parliament. And any time we are debating the Second Reading of the Appropriation Bill, the Minister for Finance is here. This is an aggregate of every Motion or every expenditure that the Government wants to do. So, we cannot therefore limit it to the contribution of one person. That is alien to our rules. Even the Minister for Finance seated here, after listening to contributions from both Sides, with concluding comments from the Majority and Minority Leaders, the Minister for Finance will still have an opportunity to listen to us.

Mr Speaker, these are figures that we are going to interrogate. If it is the case that there is an equally important programme organised by Parliament,

then we can suspend debate to continue tomorrow. But we cannot—Parliament has a carols service, and we need to understand. So, if it is the case that we are going to attend, the debate can continue tomorrow, or else, our Side is ready to debate now. But I want to appeal to the Hon Majority Leader that we cannot rush the Appropriation Bill. That would be alien to our rules. That is alien to the practice, and will not be democratic that the Minister is asking for GH¢357 billion, and we will not be allowed to talk about it, that we will not be allowed to ask questions about it. We are going to give him an extra GH¢100 billion over what he asked for in 2025, and they think that nobody should talk about it.

Mr Speaker, we can do five from each Side, the Majority and Minority Leaders will conclude, then the Minister for Finance will come in. So, I want to invite the Hon Majority Leader that we cannot go by what he said, that we should debate it thoroughly and conclude on this issue, then we can pass it. Then we know that tomorrow we will have a lighter Business to do, but Mr Speaker can regulate the time.

**Mr Dafeamekpor:** Mr Speaker, this is Hon Kwaku Kwarteng's Report. It is emanating from their Side. He chairs this Committee. So, what exactly are they saying? We are saying that all the matters have been considered at the Committee level. All we are doing is a rehash of everything that has been said and

consolidated in the Report of the Chairperson of the Committee. So, there is no point in talking forever. We have to limit it.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Hon Kwaku Kwarteng?

**Mr Kwarteng:** Mr Speaker, I just want to correct what my Colleague just said, that this is Hon Kwaku Kwarteng's Report.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Kwaku Kwarteng, you are right. This is the Report of the Committee. The Report of the Committee cannot be called "Kwaku Kwarteng's report".

**Mr Kwarteng:** This is the Report of the Committee on which the NDC has majority. So, I just want my Colleague to be corrected and get this out of the records.

Thank you, Mr Speaker

**Mr Acheampong:** Mr Speaker, I am the Ranking Member for the Budget Committee. We met, we took the decision, and it was unanimous and nobody raised an eyebrow. The Report was signed by the Chairperson of the Committee. He forwarded it to me. I have it here. So, I do not get this. This is Kwaku Kwarteng's report.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Richard Acheampong and Hon Habib Iddrisu, resume your seats.

Yes, Majority and Minority Leaders, what is the way forward?

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, this is a Report of a Committee chaired by Hon Kwarteng and he has signed the Report. He says that he is recommending to us to adopt the Report. And we are saying that we are alright, we do not want to debate it, we will adopt it for him. And he is insisting that we should debate his report. I am wondering why he is insisting that we should debate his report when we have agreed with him and want to adopt it for him.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Majority Leader, honestly speaking, we need to agree on how many people are speaking and what time we are giving to them.

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, he is saying five from each Side. I think two have spoken already. The Chairperson who presented the Report, then Hon Kabiru Mahama, so two have spoken. On our Side, I think two people, so now we are left with three from each Side, that is, two Members from each Side, then the Leaders. That makes it three each. Each of us should have five minutes to speak.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** If that is the sense of the House.

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, the Hon Majority Leader should know that this Report is properly before the House, so, to continue saying that the Report is Kwaku Kwarteng's Report when the Report of the Committee is before the House, it is a Report of the House now, not the Committee. We are not in a Committee meeting.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Habib Iddrisu, what I want the Leadership to engage on is the number of people who are speaking.

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker, five from each Side then our Leaders, the Majority and the Minority Leaders will conclude. Then the Minister for Finance can come in and we are done. Hon Kwaku Kwarteng did not speak. He only presented the Report of the Committee. So, we are saying five on each Side, and then the Leaders.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, let us stop this kind of disagreement and proceed.

Yes, Hon Addo-Kenneth, you have the floor, and kindly be brief.

**Mr Daniel Nana Addo-Kenneth (NPP — Okere):** Thank you, Mr Speaker.

I am amazed that an Appropriation Bill that seeks to provide jobs and all the beautiful and fanciful things, we are preventing the good people of this nation to listen to what it says. I am amazed.

But, Mr Speaker, I am surprised because a lean Government that is supposed to have 60 Ministers is requesting for GH¢540 million as compensation at the Office of Government Machinery. This is supposed to be a lean Government, Mr Speaker. Juxtaposing that to the fact that we still have nurses who were assured to

be paid, but have worked for 11 months, and only 1 month has been paid.

7:24 p.m.

Mr Speaker, this Appropriation seeks to create jobs. Surprisingly, when it comes to tourism, and I begin with tourism because this month is supposed to be “Detty” December. But we all saw how those who were supposed to manage the Black Stars managed the “Detty” December, and now we are losing a lot of revenue to our Nigerian counterparts. But, GHC250,000 has been given for tourism development, yet GHC500 million has been given to the Office of Government Machinery as compensation.

Mr Speaker, we have a lot of tourist attractions. Yesterday, our senior Colleague presented that of Takoradi. Before that, the Deputy Minister for Finance talked about how Akosombo had become a tourism hub. Yet, only GHC300,000 is being appropriated for tourism facility monitoring. Meanwhile, it is there, I am speaking to it, Mr Speaker. The Minister is asking for the item number; it is item 01604. It talks about 300,000. We have a lot of tourist sites, and this year, we have even issued a statement about the potential of tourism, yet, we are only appropriating GHC300,000 to monitor this facility. How will we improve these areas?

Mr Speaker, we talked about the fact that we want to create jobs, especially in

agribusiness. In agriculture, we all pay lip service to the fact that it is the basis of this economy. Yet, for agribusiness development, the Minister is only seeking to appropriate GHC400,000. No capital expenditure, it is only for goods and services. These are issues that have to be looked at in terms of how much the Minister wants to spend.

My argument is that if we are creating the impression that we want to create jobs, then the request for expenditure should reflect the intention of the Budget. However, the money that the Minister is seeking in terms of job creation, job employment, is something that does not tell me that indeed—Mr Speaker, we talked about a lot of skills development, apprenticeship and all that. This Government came on the back of job creation. This Government came on the back of a 24-Hour Economy. To even develop that, we need the skills.

Under the Ministry of Labour, Jobs and Employment, I was again amazed to see that GHC437,000 is being allocated to skills development. And this is surprising. Mr Speaker, I keep hammering on jobs because a lot of the young people — and for us, if we look at this Chamber, more than 60 per cent of the Members of Parliament here are young people. And I believe that one of the things that we ought to advocate for our people in terms of Government expenditure is job creation, but we cannot find it. Rather, we find areas that are not directly creating jobs.

Mr Speaker, the Minister mentioned yesterday that the GH¢13 billion for the Big Push project will be ringfenced. Maybe I need some more clarification. I have gone through the Appropriation, and I have not seen anywhere that GH¢13 billion has been added for spending. We only have the allocation for 2026, which is the GH¢13 billion. Yet we cannot find the GH¢13 billion that the Minister indicated they would ringfence in the Big Push project we talk about, which is expected to accelerate development and open up our major cities. So, my question is, how are we going to have that money available to spend? So, Mr Speaker, there are very fundamental issues that are questioned with this Appropriation Bill. The earlier speaker mentioned many of them.

Mr Speaker, what I need to indicate is that, having combed through this Appropriation Bill, I do not see any prospects in terms of the expenditure that is going to give us jobs. So, I would urge that maybe next year the Minister should come again in the Mid-Year to demonstrate that the expenditure is going to give us jobs. Mr Speaker, this year, we requested GH¢200 billion for expenditure, which included the Youth in Agriculture Programme. We are going away for Christmas, and Mr Speaker, when I went home, the cost of fowls and cocks has risen. Why? Because the Nkokɔ Nketenkete project, with about one million broilers and kuroilers, which would bring down the cost of chicken

and fowl, we did not find it. I would urge that just as this year we could not spend on creating these jobs, at least, during Easter, I would request the Minister to make funds available enough so we can start the Nkokɔ Nketenkete project and target the Easter market.

Mr Speaker, I would conclude by saying that this Appropriation, for me, does not give hope to the young people of this country. It does not indicate expenditure and therefore, I request the Minister take a close look at it so that we can spend in areas that will get jobs.

Thank you, Mr Speaker. *[Hear! Hear!]*

**Second Deputy Majority Whip (Mr Richard Acheampong):** Mr Speaker, I want you to guide the House. We are doing appropriation. And Appropriation is a summation of all the estimates we have done. I refer Members to page 161 of the Budget. Below the item, we see the Appropriation of GH¢357,105,639,080. Nothing has changed. We have given approval to all the estimates. We have debated the principles. So, we are only repeating ourselves. What are we doing here again?

So, Mr Speaker, unless maybe the numbers have changed or there has been some realignment, then we will bring those issues to the attention of the Minister for Finance for correction. All

Members who spoke attended the Committee meeting; they did not raise all those issues, apart from Hon Kabiru, who did not attend the meeting. Yet, he is crying more than any other person here.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Richard Acheampong, if you have nothing to say apart from asking the Speaker to guide the House, can you resume your seat?

**Mr R. Acheampong:** Mr Speaker, no, I am debating, but I want you to guide us. I am supporting the approval of the Appropriation. But the point is that we have already done all these things. So an amount of GH¢357,105,639,080 be approved for the Government for 2026. That is all. And if they want to get to know the details, I have referred Members to pages 161 and 185. Why are we wasting time? Our health is very important.

Mr Speaker, we have already given approval to all the estimates. There is no variation; we are not correcting any numbers. I call on every Member to support the approval of the Appropriation so that the states can get money to pay all of us come 2026.

I thank you very much for the opportunity. *[Hear! Hear!]*

7:34 p.m.

**Mr Agyare:** Mr Speaker, I am surprised the Hon Majority Leader tried to prevent Hon Members from commenting on this Report. This Report is being presented to the House for total consideration, but the Hon Majority Leader was not interested —

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, I would say if you also have nothing to say, apart from the Hon Majority Leader preventing, then resume your seat.

**Mr Agyare:** Mr Speaker, I have something to say.

Considering the Report, we have a compensation of GH¢90 billion, which a Colleague on the other Side tried to explain that it has to do with salary wages and that we should not say anything against it, but when we consider the goods and services, we have GH¢13 billion, so the Government is interested in paying people, and yet the moneys for the goods and services for work is GH¢13 billion, which is not enough.

Mr Speaker, apart from that, during the Committee's meeting, we realised that releases were the biggest challenge. All the Ministers sitting here know. When they met with the Committee, they complained, but when



they came to the House, they are saying we should not comment. We are only going to speak on your behalf because they have their wish list here, and they are not getting the money.

Mr Speaker, it is not about the beginning of everything, but it is about how it will end. Now, they have so much for the Appropriation Bill, but let us ask ourselves, how much releases were made?

Mr Speaker, observations were made that some agencies received 19 per cent of their allocations, and we have Colleagues on the other Side who witnessed the same thing. This is the time we have to advise the Hon Minister that with the allocations made, we might not have a problem with it, but for the agencies to be able to work, the money should be released to them. MMDAs did complain; some could not even meet 50 per cent of their budgetary allocations.

Mr Speaker, we also witnessed in the last Budget that an amount of GH¢279 billion was allocated to the GoldBod, and in the Mid-Year Budget Review, we realised that it had disappeared.

Mr Speaker, when we found out that the GoldBod allocation was coming in again, they said no. But according to the Hon Minister, they arranged with commercial banks that were interested in forex. Meaning they would take money from them to buy gold and give it to them, but to which agreement, we do not

know. We are telling the Hon Minister for Finance that now that he did not feature the GoldBod this year, we are not expecting him to bring anything in the future. The question is who is responsible for the monies being taken from these commercial banks?

Mr Speaker, we also realised that with Youth Employment Agency, the Committee also observed that there was a strange amount for validation. A huge amount of GH¢896.2 million has been allocated for validation for YEA, but this validation alone is costing us almost GH¢1 billion. In 2024, we spent GH¢47 million; in 2025, we spent GH¢95 million in total for goods and services. But for this year, it is GH¢196 million. I think that this Government also needs to consider the monies given to YEA and their programmes.

Mr Speaker, we have GH¢14.7 billion for the Big Push for infrastructure projects in various sectors. If that is the case, then why is it that GH¢14.7 billion is being allocated to the Big Push? Why are the monies not being allocated to the various MMDAs to do their own projects?

Mr Speaker, considering this Budget, the Government has programmed to appropriate a total of GH¢24.82 billion for amortisation, and the financing aspect of this Budget is GH¢90 billion. They have GH¢90 billion for financing, yet they have programmed GH¢24.8 billion for

amortisation; meaning the Government is going to borrow monies to finance this Budget and also to pay its debt.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, are you done?

**Mr Agyare:** Mr Speaker, it means that the Government is only interested in borrowing. But when we borrow money to finance the Budget and also borrow money to pay for debt, then it means that we are going to change from one lender to the other.

In conclusion, Mr Speaker, this Government should learn how to release monies for the MMDAs to be able to perform. It does not matter the total Appropriation; it is about the releases. If they do not release, they are killing our agencies.

*[Hear! Hear!]*

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes, Mr Kwame Agbodza.

**Mr Agbodza:** Mr Speaker, I thank you for the opportunity to speak in favour of the Motion to approve the Appropriation Bill (No.2), 2025.

Mr Speaker, all we are doing is to approve the revenue expenditure plan of the Government for 2026. I want to commend the Hon Minister for Finance for managing the economy in such a good way that in 2024, when we are sitting on the other Side, it would have

been a miracle to imagine that today, the interest rate in this country would be 6.5 per cent. It would have been a miracle to think that there would be a government that would actually stop the Cedi from a free fall. Today, the Dollar is less than GH¢12.

Mr Speaker, I notice that anytime Colleagues from this Side are speaking, our Colleagues from the other Side deliberately do not pay attention, which is not very good. So, the Hon Minority Leader, it is important that when we are speaking, just the way our Leader actually listens to them, he should help them listen.

Mr Speaker, what are we talking about? The Government of President Mahama has actually managed the economy well. It is out of that that while the Colleagues on the other Side mismanaged the economy, and in the sector of road and highways, actually over-procured projects to the tune of GH¢110 billion and left unpaid bills of over GH¢40 billion. Under President Mahama, GH¢6 billion of that has already been paid, and I insist that is the biggest ever single payment to contractors in our recent history, and all these projects were projects awarded and unpaid for by the opposite Side. So, when we are talking about prudence, we cannot take lessons from the opposite Side, because they know nothing about prudence.

Mr Speaker, what do we want to use these moneys for? We want these monies to complete the Kasoa to Winneba Road that has been started, and the contractor's rate certificate cannot be paid. We want to pay for the project where the Winneba roundabout will now be an interchange. We want to pay the contractor working from Winneba to Mankessim currently.

Mr Speaker, what do we want to pay for? We want to pay for the project from Takoradi to Agona junction that was awarded, and US\$78 million was raised as the owner's certificate, but not a dime has been paid until now; not a dime! Yet they took the opportunity to say that they have awarded it.

Mr Speaker, what do we want to pay for? This Budget is saying that when we raise the revenue, the interchange project, which was abandoned, is now a Big Push, which will be continued and completed; this is what we are paying for. The Wenchi to Sawla road, which has been abandoned, is under a Big Push project. The revenue from this Budget will be paid for that. The project, which is Wa to Bolgatanga, which everybody has forgotten about, is under contract. When we raise this revenue, that road will be completed.

Mr Speaker, what are we talking about? We are talking about a road between Atimpoku all the way to Aflao, which is under contract now. When we raise revenue here, we will be paying for that one as well.

Mr Speaker, the third ring road in Tamale, which is under contract now, will be paid for from this. The outer ring road of Kumasi, the first quadrant, will be paid for from that.

Mr Speaker, the Enchi, Kojokrom and Pakyi road, which is under contract now, will be paid for. The Bediako Junction to Camp 15 and Sefwi Adabokrom road will be paid for from this.

7:44 p.m.

The abandoned Adenta-Dodowa Road they left which the contractor is back on site will be paid from this revenue. Mr Speaker, the Gbintiri to Nankpanduri Road which is now back on track will be paid for from this revenue. Do they want more? Mr Speaker, there is a lot that is going on.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Member, we know there is a lot but kindly wind up?

**Mr Agbodza:** To cap it, the Colleagues on the other Side, especially Dr Kabiru, have the right to speak, but I have an issue. It was his government and his former boss, Dr Mahamudu Bawumia, who brought a Bill to this House that we will build a road between Savelugu and Walewale. His government brought the contract and paid that contractor US\$29 million. Dr Bawumia, as the head of the Economic Management Team, brought a Bill to this House that we should approve over US\$150 million for the construction of

the Savelugu to Walewale Road. That government, under President Akufo-Addo, wrote a contract and we paid that contractor US\$29 million as mobilisation. That contractor did not even do a kilometre of road. He took our money and took the money away out of this country.

So, I was surprised when Dr Kabiru actually had the courage to ask a question about the same road in this House. I was hoping that Dr Kabiru would join me to pursue that contractor who took our US\$ 29 million because that money is needed today.

Mr Speaker, I conclude that the government of President Mahama, under the leadership of Dr Ato Forson is managing the economy well. That is why today, the Minority Leader is happy that a contractor working on the road in his Constituency is working. That is why the Deputy Minority Leader is happy that the Suame Interchange project contractor is back on site. Everybody here knows a road in their backyard which is under Big Push project, which is ongoing. This is unprecedented.

Under the Year of Roads 1 and the Year of Roads 2, they should show me one road that they have started and completed. All we saw was that President Akufo-Addo came and sat there during the Message on the State of the Nation and said he has constructed 10,800 kilometres of new roads and they did a diligent work. That was untruth. No 10,800 kilometres of roads were completed.

Mr Speaker, I recommend to the Colleagues to approve this Appropriation Bill, so that we raise the revenue and apply it to the programmes that we are talking about.

Thank you very much, Mr Speaker, for the opportunity.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, we had an agreement. The Clerk to Parliament has been moving from left to right trying to stop this debate. Colleagues, we had an agreement. It is his turn, he has prepared. Let him finish then I will come in. This thing is becoming one too many. If for any reason they think that we are hard pressed with time because of the Carol's night service, let us place this on ice and come tomorrow and do it. Then, please, let us go by the agreement, Mr Speaker. It is his turn before I come in. Please, Mr Speaker, I want to show you all reverence. I got a signal from the Clerk to Parliament. Hon Clerk, please.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Minority Leader, the Clerk to Parliament is not presiding over the House, I am the one presiding over the House. Leave the Clerk alone. You have the floor.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, Leadership had a plan. It is his turn. We all agreed, and we have not changed what we agreed.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, Hon Habib proposed five on each Side. Then he proposed three on each Side. Now I have decided

to take three on each Side, include the Leaders, to make it four on each Side.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, in this Budget, Government is seeking approval from Parliament to spend in excess of GH¢350 billion. What we know is that in 2025, after we approved the Budget and the Minister came here during Mid-Year Budget Review for further actions to be taken by Parliament, no releases at all were made to Ministers.

Mr Speaker, apart from compensation, a lot of the Ministers complained at Committee hearing. Some said just around 19 per cent releases, and some 20 per cent. I want the Minister for Finance to tell us on this Floor the percentage of releases he made to the various Ministries. It is not about the Budget; it is how much he released. We know that in 2025, the Ministry of Finance failed almost all the Ministries. Many agencies of state did not have what it takes to do their work.

Let me turn my attention to job creation. We see huge sums of money being allocated for some other priorities. But the sectors that will create jobs, we see a go-slow. This Government has soon forgotten that it made two major promises to the people of Ghana. One, the Women's Development Bank. In the 2025 Budget, nothing was heard about the Women's Development Bank. So, year one is gone, they failed. In 2026, they have provided for GH¢412 million, meanwhile, the minimum capital required to set it up is GH¢400 million.

So, in other words, after setting it up, after meeting the minimum requirement, what would they have to give out as loans? We know that the law says we cannot impair the minimum capital, so they cannot touch it. We do not trust them. We cannot trust the figures. Where is the Women's Development Bank?

They also said they were going to create one job with three shifts. One hundred and eighty-nine Members of Parliament cannot take care of the many jobless youths who are seeking for jobs. A government that cannot take care of its 189 in this Chamber cannot take care of the many youths. Their Backbench in this House is suffering, yet they say they are going to create jobs. When their own Backbench have been rendered redundant and cannot go to their constituencies, they say they are going to create jobs. This Government is a promise and fail government.

They said they were going to do public sector reforms, so they appointed a Minister. If we look into this Budget, no serious provision is made. Yet they are allocating billions for certain activities. They also said they have a Minister in Charge of Special Initiatives. Where is the budgetary allocation? They can continue to talk, but their actions would expose them.

Today, they have increased electricity tariffs by 27 per cent. Did we go or did we come? If we go in here, the Minister for Roads and Highways who spoke for about 19 minutes said that some roads are going to be constructed.

He said so many roads are going to be constructed.

7:54 p.m.

I want to ask him, who is supervising the Big Push? It is not coming under the Ministry of Roads and Highways. The GH¢30 billion that has been allocated, we do not know which Minister is going to supervise its expenditure. So, we know the lack of transparency in the spending of this allocation. Mr Speaker, I have circled something for the Minister.

Mr Speaker, the allocation for Road Maintenance Trust Fund—The Minister for Roads and Highways is here, only GH¢3 billion has been allocated for road maintenance for the whole country. We have rural communities, our people need access and he could not provide for them. He is always seated by the Minister for Finance but that proximity has not earned him anything. He has been doing “follow follow”, yet he could not get enough money, only GH¢3 billion for road maintenance.

Mr Speaker, when earlier their Colleague, Hon Adongo, was speaking, they were all shouting hear! hear! What Hon Adongo needs is a job, not to do the talking. We in the Minority are united in supporting Hon Adongo who is jobless. He is always on the Floor attacking the Minority, yet he is jobless. By the Bank of Ghana enactment, he has even lost the only job he has.

Mr Speaker, let me turn to the national security budget. That is where I

want the Minister for Finance to look at his numbers. We were told that GH¢3,751,733,088.00 was the total allocation. I did not do Economics, I did not do Mathematics, mine was Law. But what we have here is basic Mathematics. Just as we exposed them at paragraphs 75 and 76 of the Budget. Again, we are exposing them, and they should pay attention. They told us National Security Council (NSC), GH¢2,441,977,235.00. Then they are saying that out of this NSC headquarters was GH¢2.441 billion, that is alright because compensation for research is zero. We understand that. Move to the next column, Good and Services, they said is GH¢1.25 billion. Then we come and say out of which research department is allocated GH¢54 million. If we add the figures, they still get GH¢2.5 billion. *Ebei!*

Mr Speaker, CAPEX, they have provided for GH¢59 million. Then they say out of which research is allocated GH¢10 million. They add and still get GH¢59 million. Why? Mr Speaker, we realise that the figure that has been provided for in the Appropriation would therefore be wrong. Yes, in the Appropriation, they have provided for GH¢3.751 billion. However, I did not do Mathematics, but this one, I will not fail. Then come and correct what you have stated in your Budget. They cannot tell me that I should concentrate on the final outcome, but not on the calculation. Mr Speaker, if you add, it is in excess of the GH¢3.751 billion.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, kindly conclude.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, we have reconciled, so allow me. Do not do this. You and I have reconciled.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Kindly conclude.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** I hear you.

Mr Speaker, if we look at this whole Budget, there were priority areas. The Ministry of Food and Agriculture needed major investment to boost food production. Meanwhile, the prudent management of the economy has resulted in the purchasing of presidential jets. Those who said they are managing the economy prudently have decided to buy a presidential jet, when they could not provide for agriculture. As for the Ministry of Trade, Agribusiness and Industry, it is a forgotten Ministry. The very policies to create jobs and to create an enabling environment for the private sector, this Government forgot about it. They cancelled the incentive for the private sector without providing an alternative. And now, they brought a Bill to this Parliament telling us that whenever there is seasonal shortfall in revenue projection, Bank of Ghana should lend them money. They turn around and say that they would only take money from the Bank of Ghana for

emergency purposes, then they smuggle in a provision to allow them to borrow when through their inefficiencies they are unable to raise revenue.

Mr Speaker, I shall conclude by saying that this Appropriation, even when it is approved, offers no hope. This Government, in year one, could not perform even up to 30 per cent of its own Budget. Clearly, in 2026, without providing for job creation under their own 24-Hour Economy, under the one job, three shifts, there is no hope at all for the youth. What we rather know is that the two Ministers who were supposed to undertake key reforms—

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, you indicated you were concluding.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Yes, I am concluding, Sir. The two Ministers, the Minister for Public Sector Reforms, has been rendered redundant. Nothing was provided. She is just at Jubilee House, doing nothing. The Minister in charge of Special Initiatives has also been made redundant. He is just being paid salary for nothing. What we know is that so much has been loaded at Jubilee House for compensation. They say they are appointing only 60 Ministers, but many Government appointees: Director of Agriculture at the Presidency, Special Advisor in charge of Agriculture at the Presidency, in addition to a Minister for Food and Agriculture. *Ebei!*

I am concluding to say that *ni amε yakeε youth le akεε amε baahã amε nitsumɔ, aabi akεε ηgbε nitsumɔ le yɔɔ, amε bε eko*. 24-Hour Economy, *amε miimale*. To wit, they — [*... Expunged by order of Mr Speaker*]

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, you know the use of the word — is offensive, so I would ask that it be expunged. And with all due respect, you have concluded nicely. I would then give five minutes to the Minister for Finance.

**Alhaji Habib Iddrisu:** Mr Speaker—

8:04 p.m.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Habib, you do not have the right to do what you are doing. Please, resume your seat.

Hon Majority Leader.

**Mr Ayariga:** Mr Speaker, all of us in this Chamber, I believe, went to secondary school. And everyone who went to secondary school did Mathematics. The Minority Leader said that even though he went to secondary school, he did not study Mathematics.

Mr Speaker, as for me, I will only debate people who have done mathematics. [*Hear! Hear!*] Since he did not do the mathematics, I will not debate him. I will allow the Minister for Finance to debate him. [*Hear! Hear!*]

**Minister for Finance (Dr Cassiel Ato Baah Forson) (MP):** Thank you very much, Mr Speaker.

Mr Speaker, now, I will take him to Mathematics class. In fact, everyone in this Chamber believes that President Mahama has made progress on the economy. [*Hear! Hear!*] Our Colleagues opposite us, deep in their hearts know that Ghana is making progress. Mr Speaker, we have been prudent and will remain prudent.

Mr Speaker, I heard my Colleague say that a prudent Government plans to buy a presidential jet. But the fact remains that it is better to buy than to rent. The cost of buying is equivalent to two years of renting aircraft under the previous administration. The fact is there for all of us to see. So who is prudent? Mr Speaker, the cost of the abandoned cathedral is more than enough to buy an aircraft. So, President Mahama is prudent.

Mr Speaker, let me say that under this budget, and the Appropriations before us, the fact remains that we will not borrow from the Central Bank. We will not ask the Bank of Ghana to print for us, as was done some years ago. We will not. Mr Speaker, we are asking this House to approve GHC13.1 billion from the Appropriation Bill for goods and services. This means that the Government is spending more than it spent this year to run the activities of the Government.



Mr Speaker, aside from that, our Colleagues opposite, when they were in office, left us a gargantuan debt; a debt that has been restructured. To the extent that, on 3<sup>rd</sup> January, 2026, the Government of Ghana will have to service the Eurobond that they borrowed. An amount of US\$70 million is due for us to service. This budget is going to pay for that. That is what this Appropriations Bill is seeking to do.

Mr Speaker, let me refer you to this. Under interest payments, we have projected GH¢57.7 billion to service the debt they left behind. In fact, this would have been more if this Government had not put in place prudent debt management strategies. So, we are only cleaning up. This budget is only going to clean up, and we will spend the GH¢57.7 to service the debt that will fall due.

Mr Speaker, aside from that, we have allocated GH¢63.5 billion for the National Health Insurance Fund, the Ghana Education Trust Fund, the Road Fund, the District Assemblies Common Fund, and other earmarked funds, including the Youth Employment Agency, the Student Loan Trust Fund, the Ghana Exim Bank, and the Minerals Development Fund. Mr Speaker, all of this amount will be made available in the year 2026, when this Appropriation Bill is passed.

We have scaled up social spending. As a result, in this budget, outside the critical social spending, we have also

allocated an amount of GH¢3.4 billion for the School Feeding Programme, Capitation Grant, and, in fact, the Livelihood Empowerment Against Poverty (LEAP). So, for LEAP alone, we are spending GH¢1.5 billion. Let me put on record that the capital expenditure has been moved from under GH¢30 to GH¢57. The Government of Ghana is spending big on infrastructure; GH¢57 million has been allocated.

Mr Speaker, let me put on record that no government in the Fourth Republic has spent more on roads than President John Dramani Mahama. *[Hear! Hear!]* That is a fact. This is because the road sector has been neglected over the years. And that is why, Mr Speaker, we are spending to fix the roads. Let me also put on record that, in this budget, we are provisioning to spend GH¢29.8 billion for the services of paying arrears. These are 103 years the NPP left behind. The contractors they failed to pay. Aside from that, we are going to spend GH¢24.8 billion for the purpose of paying down the debt they left behind.

Mr Speaker, you can see that he cannot take it anymore. Clearly, he cannot take it anymore. But let me say this year has been good; next year will be even better. It will be better for the people of Ghana. I so submit, Mr Speaker.

*Question put and Motion agreed to.*

Appropriation (No.2) Bill, 2025 accordingly read a Second time.

8:14 p.m.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, in view of the fact that our Colleagues were urging upon us to speed up because we all are pressed for time and the President is attending Carol's Night, I think this is an appropriate time to bring closure to proceedings so that we come tomorrow. I am supposed to read at the Carol's Night. We are all supposed to go and change and attend.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Minority Leader, we have sat above five hours, so that is within my domain.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** I agree. Mr Speaker, I was just drawing your attention.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** So that is within my domain. That does not lie in your mouth.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** I was just drawing your attention.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Yes. I am also telling you that that does not lie within your mouth. It is entirely in my domain. I am fortified by Standing Order 56(2).

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, what does it provide? What does it say?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** You can read it. To adjourn after five hours, it lies in me.

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Which one did you quote, please?

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Standing Order 56(2).

**Osahen Afenyo-Markin:** Mr Speaker, just a second.

**Mr First Deputy Speaker:** Hon Members, I will proceed to have the House adjourn.

## ADJOURNMENT

*The House was adjourned at 8:17 p.m. till Friday, 19<sup>th</sup> December, 2025, at 12 noon.*

### **Editor's Note**

This Official Report was corrected by the House on 3<sup>rd</sup> February, 2026 as follows:

- (a) Column 7, paragraph 1, line 4,  
“was” was corrected to “were”.
- (b) Column 7, paragraph 4, line 5,  
“will” was replaced with “may”.

